“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 2

The Truth of Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In this second chapter the author reveals that Śrī Caitanya and Śrī Kṛṣṇa are one truth (*tattva*), and he proves that Brahman is the radiance of His body and the Paramātmā, the Supersoul, His part (*aṁśa*). He then proves that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the supreme shelter of the *puruṣa-avatāras* and of all living beings, and so establishes that Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa. He shows why one must know Kṛṣṇa's intrinsic nature (*svarūpa*) and His three potencies. Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* manifests in two ways, as *prābhava* and *vaibhava*; the avatāras are of two kinds, *aṁśa-avatāras* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras*; and His original pastimes are of two kinds, marked by childhood (*bālya*) and boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*). Having shown this, the author establishes that Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form (*kiśora*) is Himself the source of all avatāras. He also shows that the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) manifests as Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes, the potency of *māyā* as countless universes, and the potency of living beings (*jīva-śakti*) as countless living beings. He establishes that Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the cause of all causes and the beginning of all; He Himself has no beginning; He is the eternal form of being, consciousness and bliss, Kṛṣṇacandra Himself. And he concludes that every devotee must know the truth of his relationship with the Lord (*sambandha-jñāna*), that is, must know Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa*, His three potencies and His *vilāsas*.

*Obeisance to Gaura through examining the conclusions (*siddhānta*) of*

devotion —

শ্রীচৈতন্যপ্রভুং বন্দে বালোঽপি যদনুগ্রহাৎ ।
তরেন্নানামতগ্রাহব্যাপ্তং সিদ্ধান্তসাগরম্ ॥ ১ ॥

śrī-caitanya-prabhuṁ vande
Śrī Caitanya the Lord I worship
bālo 'pi yad-anugrahāt
a child even by whose mercy
taren nānā-mata-grāha-
may cross of various doctrines the crocodiles
vyāptaṁ siddhānta-sāgaram
infested with of conclusive truths the ocean

1 I worship Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu. By His mercy even a child can cross the ocean of conclusive truths, which is infested with the crocodiles of various doctrines.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship Śrī Caitanya Prabhu. By His mercy even an ignorant person easily crosses the ocean of conclusions (*siddhānta*), full of crocodiles and other beasts — the doctrines of every kind.

Anubhāṣya.

bālaḥ api (even one who is ignorant, a child) **yad-anugrahāt** (by whose mercy, that is, by whose compassion) **nānā-mata-grāha-vyāptam** (full of doctrines that are like crocodiles and sharks. These doctrines were proclaimed by Aulūkya, Jina, Buddha, Jaimini, Patañjali, Gotama, Kaṇāda, Kapila, Śaṅkara and Dattātreya; they quarrel with one another and are full of worldly self-interest) **siddhānta-sāgaram** (the ocean of reasoning) **taret** (crosses. That is, he counts the mixed doctrines of these worldly people as straw and comes to know Kṛṣṇa's pure feet) **śrī-caitanya-prabhum** ([that] Śrī Caitanya Prabhu) **vande** ([I] worship).

*A prayer for Śrī Caitanya's mercy, for the sake of *kīrtana* about Kṛṣṇa —*

কৃষ্ণোৎকীর্ত্তনগাননর্ত্তনকলাপাথোজনি-ভ্রাজিতা
সদ্ভক্তাবলিহংসচক্রমধুপশ্রেণীবিহারাস্পদম্ ।
কর্ণানন্দিকলধ্বনির্বহতু মে জিহ্বামরুপ্রাঙ্গণে
শ্রীচৈতন্যদয়ানিধে তব লসল্লীলাসুধাস্বর্ধুনী ॥ ২ ॥

kṛṣṇotkīrtana-gāna-nartana-kalā-pāthojani-bhrājitā
of Kṛṣṇa's loud glorification singing dancing the arts with lotuses adorned

sad-bhaktāvali-haṁsa-cakra-madhupa-śreṇī-vihārāspadam
of true devotees rows swans cakravāka birds bees swarms the place of sport

karṇānandi-kala-dhvanir vahatu me jihvā-maru-prāṅgaṇe
delighting the ears sweet murmur may flow my of the tongue desert in the courtyard

śrī-caitanya dayā-nidhe tava lasal-līlā-sudhā-svardhunī
O Śrī Caitanya of mercy O ocean Your resplendent of pastimes of nectar the heavenly Gaṅgā

2 O Śrī Caitanya, ocean of mercy! May the heavenly Gaṅgā of the nectar of Your resplendent pastimes flow through the desert courtyard of my tongue. Its lotuses are the arts of glorifying Kṛṣṇa aloud, of singing and of dancing. Rows of true devotees sport in it like swans, cakravāka birds and swarms of bees, and its sweet murmur delights the ears.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Caitanyadeva, ocean of mercy! The nectar of Your pastimes is a shining Bhāgīrathī, the Gaṅgā. May it flow unceasingly through the field of my tongue, which is like a desert courtyard. Its lotuses are loud *kīrtana* about Kṛṣṇa, singing, dancing and the like; in it sport the saintly devotees — swans, *cakravāka* birds and bees; and its current makes a soft, sweet murmur that delights everyone's ears.

Anubhāṣya.

śrī-caitanya dayā-nidhe (O Śrī Caitanya, treasury of mercy) **kṛṣṇotkīrtana-gāna-nartana-kalā-pāthojani-bhrājitā** (shining, that is, adorned, with lotuses [*pāthojani*]. These lotuses are the arts [*kalā*]: *utkīrtana*, the loud glorification of Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities, pastimes and so on, together with singing and dancing) **sad-bhaktāvali-haṁsa-cakra-madhupa-śreṇī-**

vihārāspadam (the place of play, the field of *vilāsa*, for the hosts of true, that is, pure devotees. They abide in various moods [*bhāvas*] and are like different flocks of swans, *cakravāka* birds and bees. The sense is that in these pastimes the hosts of pure devotees find the highest joy) **karṇānandi-kala-dhvaniḥ** (she whose gentle sound delights the ear and becomes an elixir for the devotees' ears. This gentle sound is the soft, sweet murmur of the streams of Hari's pastimes; the servants of Hari, who are like swans, *cakravākas* and bees, make it) **tava lasal-līlā-sudhā-svardhunī** (such is Your shining [*lasatī*, radiant] heavenly river [*svardhunī*], the Mandākinī, the heavenly Gaṅgā, full of the nectar of Gaura's pastimes) **me** (my) **jihvā-maru-prāṅgaṇe** (in the desert courtyard of the tongue. It has no taste, because it has been deprived of relishing the *rasa* of Gaura's pastimes) **vahatu** ([may she] flow).

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ৩ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaita-candra glory to Gaura's devotees host

3 All glory, all glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaita-candra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

Explanation of the third of the fourteen opening verses. Pointing out the Truth

—

তৃতীয় শ্লোকের অর্থ করি বিবরণ ।
বস্তু-নির্দ্দেশরূপ মঙ্গলাচরণ ॥ ৪ ॥

tṛtīya ślokera artha kari vivaraṇa
of the third verse the meaning I make explanation
vastu-nirdeśa-rūpa maṅgalācaraṇa
the subject defining in the form of invocation

4 Now I shall explain the meaning of the third verse, the invocation (*maṅgalācaraṇa*) that defines the subject.

যদদ্বৈতং ব্রহ্মোপনিষদি তদপ্যস্য তনুভা
য আত্মান্তর্যামী পুরুষ ইতি সোঽস্যাংশবিভবঃ ৷
ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্যৈঃ পূর্ণো য ইহ ভগবান্ স স্বয়ময়ং
ন চৈতন্যাৎ কৃষ্ণাজ্জগতি পরতত্ত্বং পরমিহ ॥ ৫ ॥

yad advaitaṁ brahmopaniṣadi tad apy asya tanu-bhā
that which non-dual Brahman in the Upaniṣads that too His the radiance of the body

ya ātmāntar-yāmī puruṣa iti so 'syāṁśa-vibhavaḥ
who the Self dwelling within the Puruṣa thus (called) he His plenary expansion

ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ pūrṇo ya iha bhagavān sa svayam ayaṁ
with the six opulences full who here Bhagavān He Himself this one

na caitanyāt kṛṣṇāj jagati para-tattvaṁ param iha
not than Caitanya Kṛṣṇa in the world Supreme Truth higher here

5 "What the Upaniṣads call the non-dual Brahman is only the radiance of His body. The one called the Puruṣa, the Supersoul dwelling within all, is His plenary expansion. And Bhagavān, full of the six opulences, is He Himself. In this world there is no Supreme Truth higher than Caitanya, who is Kṛṣṇa."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The One whom the Upaniṣads call the nondual Brahman is the radiance of my Lord's body. The One whom the scriptures of yoga call the Puruṣa who dwells within (*antaryāmī*), or Paramātmā, is a part (*aṁśa*) of my Lord. The One who is the shelter of Brahman and Paramātmā, the whole (*aṁśī*) of which they are parts, is called Bhagavān, full in the six opulences. My Lord is that Bhagavān Himself. Therefore in the world there is no Supreme Truth higher than Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.

upaniṣadi (in the Upaniṣad, that is, in a special branch of the Vedas, the highest of all, called *brahma-vidyā* [the knowledge of Brahman]. [The word *upaniṣad* is formed from the root *ṣad* with the prefixes *upa-* and *ni-* and the suffix *kvip*; the root means "to destroy," "to go" and "to wear down." Here *upa* means "having approached," that is, having received it through the guru's

instruction, and *ni* means “with resolve.” Some have approached *brahma-vidyā*, have resolutely fixed themselves in it and have lost their thirst for objects, both those that are seen and those promised in the Vedas. For them it destroys the seed of worldly existence — loosens it, wears it down, annihilates it — and leads them to Brahman.]) **yat advaitam** (that which [is called] nondual, without a second), **brahma** (Brahman), **tat api** (that too) **asya** (His [Gaura-Kṛṣṇa's]) **tanu-bhā** (is the radiance [of His transcendental body]) **yaḥ ātmā** (He who is the Self [the Paramātmā, the Controller of all living beings and the rest]), **antar-yāmī puruṣaḥ** (the Puruṣa who dwells within), **saḥ asya aṁśa-vibhavaḥ** (is His partial manifestation [one of His opulences, a particular expression of His all-pervasiveness]) **iha** ([in this examination of the truth]) **yaḥ ṣaḍ-aiśvaryaiḥ** (He who in the six opulences, that is, in the six kinds of lordship — complete wealth, strength, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation —) **pūrṇaḥ** (is full [needs nothing, is perfect]), **saḥ ayam** (He, this Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya), **svayam bhagavān** (is Bhagavān Himself) **iha** ([in the world, in the examination of the truth, or in the Kali age]) **caitanyāt kṛṣṇāt** (than Kṛṣṇa Caitanya) **param** (other) **para-tattvam** (supreme truth [better shelter]) **na** (there is none).

(Brahman is the goal of the scriptures of knowledge (*jñāna-śāstras*), and Paramātmā the goal of the scriptures of yoga. In truth they are equal to Bhagavān. But the view differs with the qualification (*adhikāra*) of the one who sees, and so they are only two aspects of Bhagavān's form — His spiritual radiance and His part. They are not the whole, complete Reality, endowed with all qualities and potencies; only Bhagavān is that.)

With this verse one should compare the following verse from Śrī Jīva Prabhu's *Tattva-sandarbha* (8): “His being, purely spiritual, receives the name Brahman in some places of the Vedas. His part is the Puruṣa, who subdues *māyā* and through His own parts displays variety. His one form sports in the spiritual sky (*paravyoma*) under the name Nārāyaṇa. May that Śrī Kṛṣṇa, Bhagavān Himself, grant love of God (*prema*) here to those who take shelter of His feet.”

Some are deprived of beholding the being and bliss (*sat* and *ānanda*) of Bhagavān, who is full of *sat*, *cit* and *ānanda*. They rely only on the function of consciousness (*saṁvit*) and, pursuing the Truth endowed with spiritual pastimes, in the end see Brahman. Others are deprived of beholding Bhagavān's bliss (*ānanda*). They rely only on the functions of being and consciousness (*sat* and *cit*) and, pursuing the same Truth, in the end see Paramātmā. Thus Bhagavān is the form of being, consciousness and bliss and of divine pastimes. The

spiritual radiance of His body is Brahman, devoid of spiritual *vilāsa* and free from *māyā*,[0] and the being that is a portion of His majesty (*aiśvarya*) is Paramātmā.

Examining the Truth —

ব্রহ্ম, আত্মা, ভগবান্ — অনুবাদ তিন ।
অঙ্গপ্রভা, অংশ, স্বরূপ — তিন বিধেয় চিহ্ন ॥ ৬ ॥

brahma, ātmā, bhagavān — anuvāda tina
Brahman the Supersoul Bhagavān subjects three
aṅga-prabhā, aṁśa, svarūpa — tina vidheya cihna
the radiance of the body the portion His own form three predicate marks

6 Brahman, the Supersoul and Bhagavān are the three subjects (*anuvāda*). The radiance of His body, His portion and His own form (*svarūpa*) are the three predicates (*vidheya*) that define them.

অনুবাদ আগে, পাছে বিধেয় স্থাপন ।
সেই অর্থ কহি, শুন শাস্ত্রবিবরণ ॥ ৭ ॥

anuvāda āge, pāche vidheya sthāpana
the subject first after the predicate is placed
sei artha kahi, śuna śāstra-vivaraṇa
that meaning I tell hear of scripture the explanation

7 The subject comes first, and the predicate is placed after it. I shall tell you the meaning of the verse in this way; now hear it explained according to scripture.

Kṛṣṇa, and the truth about Caitanya —

স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ, বিষ্ণু-পরতত্ত্ব ।
পূর্ণজ্ঞান পূর্ণানন্দ পরম মহত্ত্ব ॥ ৮ ॥

svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa, viṣṇu-paratattva
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa of Viṣṇu the Supreme Truth
pūrṇa-jñāna pūrṇānanda parama mahattva
full knowledge full bliss supreme greatness

8 Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Lord Himself (*svayaṁ bhagavān*), the Supreme Truth of all Viṣṇu forms. He is full knowledge and full bliss, and His greatness is supreme.

‘নন্দসুত’ বলি’ যাঁরে ভাগবতে গাই ।
সেই কৃষ্ণ অবতীর্ণ চৈতন্য-গোসাঞি ॥ ৯ ॥

‘nanda-suta’ bali’ yāṅre bhāgavate gāi
the son of Nanda calling whom in the Bhāgavata they sing
sei kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa caitanya-gosāñi
that Kṛṣṇa has descended Caitanya Gosāñi

9 That Kṛṣṇa, whom the Bhāgavatam glorifies as the son of Nanda, has descended as Lord Caitanya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

According to the science of poetics (*alaṅkāra-śāstra*), one first states what is already known (the *anuvāda*) and only then indicates what is said about it (the *vidheya*). In many places the Vedas and other scriptures speak of three subjects — Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān. These truths are therefore already known, and they must be taken as the *anuvāda*. But it is not yet known that Brahman is the radiance of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's body, Paramātmā His part and Bhagavān His *svarūpa*. So one must first state these three *anuvādas* and then, after examining the meaning of the scriptures, establish the *vidheya*. The conclusion of the scriptures is this: among the *viṣṇu-tattvas* the Supreme Truth is Bhagavān Kṛṣṇacandra Himself. He whom the *Bhāgavatam* sings of as the son of Nanda has descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Therefore, when I discuss the truth, I shall speak of Kṛṣṇa and Caitanya as entirely non-different. And so the Supreme Truth appears in three ways — as Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān Himself — and I may rightly call all three special manifestations of Śrī Caitanya.

প্রকাশবিশেষে তেঁহ ধরে তিন নাম ।
ব্রহ্ম, পরমাত্মা আর স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ॥ ১০ ॥

prakāśa-viśeṣe teṅha dhare tina nāma
manifestation in particular He bears three names
brahma, paramātmā āra svayaṁ bhagavān
Brahman the Supersoul and Himself Bhagavān

10 According to His particular manifestations He bears three names: Brahman, the Supersoul and Bhagavān, the Supreme Lord Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Prabhu Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (3): “Thus, when [the Truth] displays all Its distinguishing features, It is Bhagavān: He is Its full appearance and therefore the form of the undivided Truth. Brahman, however, is an incomplete appearance of that same Truth, for in Brahman the form with distinguishing features is not manifest. ‘O sage! The sound *bha* carries two meanings, *sambhartā* and *bhartā*; the meanings of the sound *ga* are *netā*, *gamayitā* and *sraṣṭā*. Beings dwell in Him, the Self of beings, the Self of all, and He, the Imperishable, abides in all beings without exception — this is the meaning of the sound *va*. Knowledge, potency, strength, lordship, power and splendor in their fullness, without inferior qualities and the like — this is what the word Bhagavān denotes.’ *Sambhartā* is He who nourishes His devotees; *bhartā*, He who sustains and establishes; *netā*, He who leads to the fruit of devotion to Him, that is, to *prema*; *gamayitā*, He who brings to His own abode; *sraṣṭā*, He who gives rise to various qualities in His devotees. (4) He Himself is not a cause: He is wholly absorbed in the *vilāsa* of His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) alone and is therefore indifferent to the world. Yet through the Puruṣa, His part, also called the Paramātmā, who sets *prakṛti* and the *jīvas* in motion, He becomes the cause of the world's creation, maintenance and so on. Know this as the form of Bhagavān. <…> As the efficient cause, He makes the *jīvas*, particles of Himself, enter bodies and the rest and so brings them to life. Impelled by Him, all the elements — *pradhāna* and the others, indicated by bodies and so on — move, that is, set about their work. Know this as the form of the Paramātmā. The *jīva* is an *ātmā*, a self, and compared with him He is the supreme (*parama*); therefore the word Paramātmā denotes just Him, the *jīva*'s

companion. That same Truth is present as the accompanying presence (*anvaya*) in dream and the other states; outside them It likewise abides in the pure potency called the *jīva*; and the particle *ca* (‘and’) shows that It also abides beyond them, separately (*vyatireka*), remaining by Itself. Know this as the form of Brahman.”

Bhagavān is endowed with all potencies and reveals Himself in all His fullness; therefore He is the undivided Truth. In Brahman such a form with distinguishing features is not manifest; therefore Brahman is only a partial, incomplete appearance of Bhagavān. O sage! The first sound of the word Bhagavān, *bha*, has two meanings, *sambhartā* and *bhartā*; the sound *ga* means *netā*, *gamayitā* and *srasṭā*. Beings dwell in the universal Self, the Self of beings, and He, the imperishable Puruṣa, dwells in all beings without exception — this is the meaning of the sound *va*. Boundless knowledge, potency, strength, lordship, power and splendor, without inferior qualities — this is what the word Bhagavān denotes. *Sambhartā* means “He who nourishes His devotees”; *bhartā*, “He who sustains and establishes”; *netā*, “He who leads to the fruit of devotion to Him, that is, to *prema*”; *gamayitā*, “He who brings to His own abode”; *srasṭā*, “He who gives rise to various qualities in His devotees.” There is a Truth that is not Itself a cause: through Its own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) It has a single *vilāsa* and is entirely indifferent to the world. And yet, through the Puruṣa, Its part, who sets *prakṛti* and the *jīvas* in motion, It becomes the cause of the world's birth, maintenance and so on. Know this as the truth of Bhagavān (*bhagavat-tattva*). There is One who, as the efficient cause, makes the *jīvas*, particles of Himself, enter the world and so brings the world to life. Impelled by Him, the elements — *pradhāna* and the others, indicated by bodies and so on — remain in place and each sets about its own work. Know Him as the Paramātmā. By his intrinsic nature the *jīva* is an *ātmā*, and the One higher than the *jīva* is *parama*; therefore the word Paramātmā reveals Him as the *jīva*'s eternal companion. There is a Truth that is present as the accompanying presence (*anvaya*) in waking, dreaming and deep sleep. In *samādhi* It abides [as] the pure *jīva-śakti*, yet afterwards It also abides beyond it, separately (*vyatireka*), remaining by Itself. Know It as Brahman.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.11)*

বদন্তি তত্তত্ত্ববিদস্তত্ত্বং যজ্‌জ্ঞানমদ্বয়ম্‌ ।
ব্রহ্মেতি পরমাত্মেতি ভগবানিতি শব্দ্যতে ॥ ১১ ॥

vadanti tat tattva-vidas
declare that the knowers of the Truth
tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam
the Truth which knowledge non-dual
brahmeti paramātmeti
Brahman as the Supersoul as
bhagavān iti śabdyate
Bhagavān as is named

11 "The knowers of the Truth declare that the Truth is non-dual knowledge. It is named Brahman, the Supersoul and Bhagavān." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those who know the truth call nondual knowledge the Truth. This nondual knowledge is first perceived as Brahman, then as Paramātmā, and thirdly as Bhagavān.

Anubhāṣya.

The sages headed by Śaunaka asked Sūta, the disciple of Śukadeva, six questions. This verse answers the second of them: "What is the essence of the scriptures?"

tattva-vidaḥ (those who know the truth) **tat** ([just] that) **tattvam** (the Truth), **advayam jñānam** (nondual knowledge [one, purely spiritual]), **vadanti** (they call) **yat** ([This nondual knowledge]) **brahma iti** ([in some places] Brahman), **paramātmā iti** ([in some places] Paramātmā), **bhagavān iti ca** ([and in some places] Bhagavān) **śabdyate** (is called).

The sense is this: nondual knowledge realized through the function of knowledge alone is Brahman; nondual knowledge realized through the functions of being and consciousness (*sat* and *cit*) is Paramātmā; and that same nondual knowledge realized through the functions of being, consciousness and bliss (*sat*, *cit* and *ānanda*) is Bhagavān.

Bhagavān's devotees know that the embodiment of nondual knowledge is Vrajendranandana, the son of the king of Vraja. In Kṛṣṇa's name, form, qualities and pastimes they see nothing second. If one separates Kṛṣṇa from His transcendental name, form, qualities and pastimes, a mundane conception of Viṣṇu's body arises; this is the very absence of nondual knowledge. Things other than Kṛṣṇa are not Viṣṇu, and nondual knowledge is not in them. Therefore everything other than Kṛṣṇa is separated from Kṛṣṇa, that is, from nondual knowledge, by *māyā*, or dual knowledge.[0] So it becomes liable to fall under *māyā*'s control, and is therefore subject to *māyā*, or dual knowledge. In all of Kṛṣṇa's manifestations (*prakāśas*) and forms of *vilāsa*, however, there is no knowledge of anything second; therefore they are *viṣṇu-tattva* and the masters of *māyā*. The yogīs regard only one state as free from knowledge of a second: the unmixed union (*yoga*) of the pure soul with the Paramātmā, the embodiment of nondual knowledge. The *jñānīs*, for their part, regard as nondual knowledge, as Brahman, a featureless knowledge free from all distinctions — internal, homogeneous and heterogeneous (*svagata*, *sajātīya* and *vijātīya*). See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on the *Bhāgavatam* by the author of this commentary, pp. 88–89.

(1) Examining Brahman —

তাঁহার অঙ্গের শুদ্ধ কিরণ-মণ্ডল ।
উপনিষদ্ কহে তাঁরে ব্রহ্ম সুনির্ম্মল ॥ ১২ ॥

tāṅhāra aṅgera śuddha kiraṇa-maṇḍala
His of the body pure of rays the halo
upaniṣad kahe tāṅre brahma sunirmala
the Upaniṣads call it Brahman utterly pure

12 The pure halo of rays from His body is what the Upaniṣads call the utterly pure Brahman.

Anubhāṣya.

Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad, second *muṇḍaka*, second *khaṇḍa*, mantras 9–11: “In the highest, golden sheath dwells Brahman, stainless and undivided. It is pure, the light of lights; those who know the Self know It. There the sun does not shine, nor the moon and stars, nor do these lightnings shine — how then this fire? As He shines, everything shines after Him; by His light all this is illumined. Truly,

Brahman is this immortal one: Brahman in front, Brahman behind, Brahman to the right and to the left, below and above — spread everywhere. Truly, Brahman is all this, this most excellent universe."

চর্ম্মচক্ষে দেখে যৈছে সূর্য্য নির্ব্বিশেষ ।
জ্ঞানমার্গে লইতে নারে তাঁহার বিশেষ ॥ ১৩ ॥

carma-cakṣe dekhe yaiche sūrya nirviśeṣa
with fleshly eyes one sees as the sun featureless
jñāna-mārge laite nāre tāṅhāra viśeṣa
on the path of knowledge to grasp cannot His distinctive features

13 To the physical eye the sun appears featureless. In the same way, on the path of knowledge one cannot grasp His distinctive features.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Nirviśeṣa. A *viśeṣa* is a feature by which a thing is recognized; what lacks such features is *nirviśeṣa*, featureless.

*(*Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.40)*

যস্য প্রভা প্রভবতো জগদণ্ডকোটি-
কোটিষ্বশেষবসুধাদিবিভূতিভিন্নম্ ।
তদ্ব্রহ্মনিষ্কলমনন্তমশেষভূতং
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ১৪ ॥

yasya prabhā prabhavato jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-
whose effulgence of the mighty one of universes of millions
koṭiṣv aśeṣa-vasudhādi-vibhūti-bhinnam
in millions countless earths and other by opulences differentiated
tad brahma niṣkalam anantam aśeṣa-bhūtaṁ
that Brahman undivided infinite complete
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

14 "I worship Govinda, the original Person. In the millions upon millions of universes of that mighty Lord, His effulgence appears differentiated by

countless opulences, such as earths. That effulgence is Brahman — undivided, infinite and complete." (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I worship Govinda, the original Puruṣa. From His radiance comes Brahman — undivided, infinite, boundless, and distinct from the countless opulences of millions and millions of universes, such as their lands.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Brahmā set forth the truth and greatness of Śrī Govinda in the form of a prayer; it is given in the fifth chapter of the *Brahma-saṁhitā*.

jagad-aṇḍa-koṭi-koṭiṣu (in millions and millions of universes, that is, in countless universes) **aśeṣa-vasudhādi-vibhūti-bhinnam** (distinct, that is, set apart, by the opulences — the countless universes and all else that has form and so on) **niṣkalam** ([that which is] without parts: undivided, perfect), **anantam** (beyond limited knowledge), **aśeṣa-bhūtam** (boundless —) **tat brahma** (that Brahman) **prabhavataḥ** ([of the One endowed with power]) **yasya** (whose [Govinda's]) **prabhā** (is the radiance of the body) **tam ādi-puruṣam govindam aham bhajāmi** (that original Puruṣa, Govinda, I worship).

কোটী কোটী ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে যে ব্রহ্মের বিভূতি ।
সেই ব্রহ্ম গোবিন্দের হয় অঙ্গকান্তি ॥ ১৫ ॥

koṭī koṭī brahmāṇḍe ye brahmera vibhūti
millions of millions in universes which of Brahman the opulence
sei brahma govindera haya aṅga-kānti
that Brahman of Govinda is the luster of the body

15 Brahman, whose opulence fills millions upon millions of universes, is the luster of Govinda's body.

সেই গোবিন্দ ভজি আমি, তেঁহো মোর পতি ।
তাঁহার প্রসাদে মোর হয় সৃষ্টিশক্তি ॥ ১৬ ॥

sei govinda bhaji āmi, teṅho mora pati
that Govinda worship I He my master
tāṅhāra prasāde mora haya sṛṣṭi-śakti
His by the grace my is the power of creation

16 I worship that Govinda; He is my master. By His grace I have the power to create.

Anubhāṣya.
"I" is Brahmā.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.6.47)*

মুনয়ো বাতবসনাঃ শ্রমণা ঊর্দ্ধমন্থিনঃ ।
ব্রহ্মাখ্যং ধাম তে যান্তি শান্তাঃ সন্ন্যাসিনোঽমলাঃ ॥ ১৭ ॥

munayo vāta-vasanāḥ
sages wind clad in
śramaṇā ūrdhva-manthinaḥ
ascetics upward drawing (their seed)
brahmākhyaṁ dhāma te yānti
called Brahman the abode they reach
śāntāḥ sannyāsino 'malāḥ
peaceful renunciants pure

17 "Sages clad only in the wind, ascetics who draw their seed upward, peaceful and pure renunciants — they reach the abode called Brahman." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.6.47)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Naked sages who practice austerity and keep their seed, and peaceful, pure *sannyāsīs*, attain the abode of Brahman.

Anubhāṣya.
Uddhava learned that Śrī Kṛṣṇa would soon withdraw from view, and in a prayer at His holy feet he said: devotees reach Kṛṣṇa's feet with ease, while *sannyāsīs* who impose hardships on themselves win the fruit of their practice by hard labor — and attain only Brahmaloka.

vāta-vasanāḥ (clothed in the wind, that is, naked, without garments) **śramaṇāḥ** (mendicant monks who emaciate the body) **ūrdhva-manthinaḥ** (who keep their seed) **śāntāḥ** (those whose minds are fixed on Brahman alone) **amalāḥ** (free from the filth of sense objects) **sannyāsinaḥ** (*sannyāsīs*) **te** (they) **brahmākhyam** (called Brahman [impersonal]) **dhāma** (the abode) **yānti** (attain).

(2) Examining Paramātmā —

আত্মান্তর্য্যামী যাঁরে যোগশাস্ত্রে কয় ।
সেহ গোবিন্দের অংশ বিভূতি যে হয় ॥ ১৮ ॥

ātmāntaryāmī yāṅre yoga-śāstre kaya
the Self, the indwelling Lord whom in the scriptures of yoga they call
seha govindera aṁśa vibhūti ye haya
He of Govinda portion manifestation of opulence indeed is

18 He whom the scriptures of yoga call the Self, the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*), is a portion of Govinda and a manifestation of His opulence.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān is a form full of spiritual *vilāsa*. He is the *turīya-vigraha*, the form beyond the three states, and so He Himself has no part in any affairs of Devī-dhāma, the material world: He controls *pradhāna* and the *jīvas* through the *puruṣa-avatāras*. As soon as the *jīva* understands the truth of the three *puruṣa-avatāras*, he is freed from perceiving the twenty-four elements of *māyā*. Kṣīrodakaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu is the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) of each *jīva*; Garbhodakaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu is the indwelling Lord of the aggregate *jīva* of the universe; and the creator of the universes, Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu, is also an indwelling Lord. These three *puruṣa-avatāras* carry out the creation of Devī-dhāma and govern this partial work. The scriptures of yoga prescribe union (*yoga*) with Paramātmā in order to pass beyond the twenty-four elements of *māyā*. Thus the indwelling Puruṣa, Paramātmā, is only a partial manifestation (*aṁśa-vibhūti*) of Govinda.

অনন্ত স্ফটিকে যৈছে এক সূর্য্য ভাসে ।
তৈছে জীবে গোবিন্দের অংশ প্রকাশে ॥ ১৯ ॥

ananta sphaṭike yaiche eka sūrya bhāse
in countless crystals as one sun is reflected
taiche jīve govindera aṁśa prakāśe
so in the living beings of Govinda the portion is manifest

19 Just as one sun is reflected in countless crystals, so Govinda's portion is manifest in all living beings.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
A single sun, reflected in countless pieces of crystal, shows itself in each as a separate image. So too Paramātmā, a part of Govinda, manifests in countless *jīvas*.

Anubhāṣya.
The one sun stays in its place and is reflected in countless pieces of crystal as countless images. So too the one Śrī Govinda, eternally manifest in Goloka-Vṛndāvana, manifests in the hearts of countless *jīvas* as the indwelling Paramātmā, the Puruṣa whom the *jīva* is meant to serve. The three mantras that begin "Two birds, inseparable friends…"[0] speak of two birds on one tree, the *jīvātmā* and Paramātmā; they stand in the relation of the servant and the One served. Paramātmā makes the *jīvātmā* taste the fruits of karma, but He Himself does not taste such fruits. When the *jīva* stops enjoying the fruits of karma and comes to know the glory of Paramātmā, whom he is meant to serve, he becomes stainless and attains the supreme equality — Vaikuṇṭha.

*(*Bhagavad-gītā* 10.42)*

অথবা বহুনৈতেন কিং জ্ঞাতেন তবার্জ্জুন ।
বিষ্টভ্যাহমিদং কৃৎস্নমেকাংশেন স্থিতো জগৎ ॥ ২০ ॥

atha vā bahunaitena
or else by much this
kiṁ jñātena tavārjuna
what by knowing your O Arjuna
viṣṭabhyāham idaṁ kṛtsnam
pervading and supporting I this entire
ekāṁśena sthito jagat
with one portion abide the universe

20 “But what need is there, Arjuna, for you to know all this in detail? I pervade and support this entire universe with a single portion of Myself.” (Bhagavad-gītā 10.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Arjuna, what more need I say? With one part of Myself, as Paramātmā, I have entered the whole universe and abide in it.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān explained to Arjuna in many ways the truth of His relationship with all that exists (*sambandha-tattva*), and in this verse He states it briefly.

atha vā (or else) **arjuna** (O Arjuna) **bahunā** (with many details, taught one by one) **jñātena kim** (what use is it [for you] to know? That is, enough) **idam** (this [made of spirit and matter]) **kṛtsnam** (entire) **jagat** (universe) **ekāṁśena** (with one part [the part called the Puruṣa, the indwelling Lord of *prakṛti* and the rest]) **viṣṭabhya** (supporting [as its foundation, bearing it; as its overseer, governing it; as its controller, subduing it; as the all-pervading one, pervading it]), **aham** (I [Bhagavān]) **sthitaḥ** (abide).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.9.42)*

তমিমমহমজং শরীরভাজাং
হৃদি হৃদি ধিষ্ঠিতমাত্মকল্পিতানাম্ ।
প্রতিদৃশমিব নৈকধার্কমেকং
সমধিগতোঽস্মি বিধূতভেদমোহঃ ॥ ২১ ॥

tam imam aham ajaṁ śarīra-bhājāṁ
Him this I the unborn of the embodied
hṛdi hṛdi dhiṣṭhitam ātma-kalpitānām
in heart in heart abiding created by Himself
prati-dṛśam iva naikadhārkam ekaṁ
to each eye like in many ways the sun one
samadhigato 'smi vidhūta-bheda-mohaḥ
have realized I am dispelled of difference the delusion

21 “My delusion of difference is gone, and I have realized Him, this unborn Lord. He abides in the heart of every embodied being He has created, just

as the one sun appears in many ways to every eye that sees it." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.9.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhīṣma said: "O Kṛṣṇa, one and the same sun appears to each eye as a separate, distinct object. So too Paramātmā, Your part, abides in the heart of every embodied being, and people take Him to be a separate truth. But when they become *ātma-kalpita* — Your own, that is, when they know themselves to be Your servants — this delusion of difference vanishes. I have come to know Paramātmā as Your part, and so I too am free from the delusion of difference: I have gained knowledge of You, who are unborn in Your own nature (*svarūpa*)."[0]

Anubhāṣya.

Yudhiṣṭhira went to Bhīṣma wishing to ask him about *dharma*, and Śrī Kṛṣṇa followed him on Arjuna's chariot. Other divine and brahminical sages (*devarṣis* and *brahmarṣis*) also gathered there to see Bhīṣma. Bhīṣma answered some of Yudhiṣṭhira's questions. Then, when the time of his departure came, he praised Śrī Kṛṣṇa, who stood before him, in many verses; this verse is one of them.

prati-dṛśam (to each eye [of beings in different places]) **naikadhā** (in many ways [because they abide in different places]), **ekam arkam iva** (like the one sun) **ātma-kalpitānām** (created by Himself) **śarīra-bhājām** (of the embodied) **hṛdi hṛdi** (in each heart) **dhiṣṭhitam** (abiding), **tam imam ajam** (this Unborn One [Śrī Kṛṣṇa]) **vidhūta-bheda-mohaḥ** (one whose delusion of difference is cast off [*vidhūta*, removed]. This delusion is the idea that Bhagavān's name, form, qualities and pastimes are different from Him. It shows itself as a perception of multiplicity: one imagines that Bhagavān's form divides into different forms — *prakāśas* and *vilāsa-mūrtis* — in order to become all-pervading) **aham** (I) **samadhigataḥ asmi** (have fully realized [attained]).

(3) Examining Bhagavān —

সেই ত' গোবিন্দ সাক্ষাচ্চৈতন্য গোসাঞি ।
জীব নিস্তারিতে ঐছে দয়ালু আর নাই ॥ ২২ ॥

sei ta' govinda sākṣāc caitanya gosāñi
that indeed Govinda directly Caitanya Gosāñi
jīva nistārite aiche dayālu āra nāi
souls in delivering so merciful another there is not

22 That same Govinda is directly Lord Caitanya. No one else is so merciful in delivering souls.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By using the word *sākṣāt* (directly, in person) here, the author establishes that Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Govinda Himself, not a *prakāśa* or *vilāsa* of Govinda.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Caitanya Upaniṣad*: "Gaura is the Self of all, the Great Person, the Great Soul, the great yogī; He is beyond the three modes and is the embodiment of pure goodness (*sattva*). He will reveal devotion in the world." In the *Śvetāśvatara*: "He is the supreme great Lord of lords, the supreme Deity of deities, the supreme Master of masters, higher than the highest. We know Him as God, the Lord of the worlds, worthy of praise." "Truly, the great Lord is the Puruṣa. He impels the intelligence toward this purest attainment; He is the Ruler, the imperishable Light." "When the seer sees the golden-colored Creator, the Lord, the Puruṣa, the source of Brahman…" "O Great Person! I bow to Your lotus feet. They are always to be meditated on; they destroy humiliation and fulfill desires; they are the refuge of the holy places, praised by Śiva and Brahmā, and they are the shelter. They destroy the sufferings of servants; O Protector of the surrendered, they are the boat on the ocean of birth and death. O most righteous One! At the word of a worthy one You gave up a glorious kingdom, so hard to renounce and coveted even by the gods, and went to the forest; You ran after the illusory deer that Your beloved desired…" "Thus, O Great Person, You descend as human, animal, sage, demigod and fish, sustain the worlds, slay the enemies of the world and protect the *dharma* proper to each age. But in Kali You came concealed (*channa*), and therefore You are Triyuga" — these are Prahlāda's words.[0]

There is no need to cite here the evidence already quoted in the *Caritāmṛta*. In the *Kṛṣṇa-yāmala*: "In the holy place Navadvīpa I shall become the son of Śacī." In the *Brahma-yāmala*: "Or else I shall descend to earth in the form of My devotee and appear in Māyā[0] in the Kali age, when *saṅkīrtana* begins." In the *Vāyu Purāṇa*: "When *saṅkīrtana* begins in the Kali age, I shall become the son

of Śacī." In the *Ananta-saṁhitā*: "That same Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa, the beloved of Rādhikā's life, who at the beginning of creation is the Lord of the universe, became Gaura, O Maheśvarī!" And so on.

Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma, is described in all the scriptures —

পরব্যোমেতে বৈসে নারায়ণ নাম ।
ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্যপূর্ণ লক্ষ্মীকান্ত ভগবান্ ॥ ২৩ ॥

para-vyomete vaise nārāyaṇa nāma
in the spiritual sky resides Nārāyaṇa named
ṣaḍ-aiśvarya-pūrṇa lakṣmī-kānta bhagavān
with the six opulences full of Lakṣmī the beloved the Lord

23 In the spiritual sky resides the Lord named Nārāyaṇa. He is full of the six opulences and is the beloved of Lakṣmī.

বেদ, ভাগবত, উপনিষদ্, আগম ।
'পূর্ণতত্ত্ব' যাঁরে কহে, নাহি যাঁর সম ॥ ২৪ ॥

veda, bhāgavata, upaniṣad, āgama
the Vedas the Bhāgavata the Upaniṣads the Āgamas
'pūrṇa-tattva' yāṅre kahe, nāhi yāṅra sama
the complete Truth whom call there is not whose equal

24 The Vedas, the Bhāgavatam, the Upaniṣads and the Āgamas call Him "the complete Truth"; no one is equal to Him.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Ṛg-veda-saṁhitā* (1.22.20): "The sages always see that supreme abode of Viṣṇu, like an eye spread across the sky," and so on. In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (11.3.34–35): "You are the best knowers of Brahman; tell us, then, of the foundation of Brahman, the Paramātmā called Nārāyaṇa." "It is the cause of the creation, maintenance and dissolution of this world, but Itself has no cause. It is present in dreaming, waking and deep sleep, and also beyond them. By It the body, the senses, the life air and the heart come alive and act. Know It as the Supreme, O king." In the *Nārāyaṇa-atharvaśira Upaniṣad*: "From Nārāyaṇa alone everything is born, by Nārāyaṇa it is set in motion, in Nārāyaṇa it dissolves. Nārāyaṇa is

eternal. All this is Nārāyaṇa alone — all that has been and all that will be. Pure is the one God Nārāyaṇa, and there is no second." In the *Nārāyaṇa Upaniṣad*: "He from whom the mother of the world was born." In the *Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra*: "The Paramātmā is the Lord Hari."

A difference in vision brings a difference in what is seen; a difference in means brings a difference in how the goal is perceived —

ভক্তিযোগে ভক্ত পায় যাঁহার দর্শন ।
সূর্য্য যেন সবিগ্রহ দেখে দেবগণ ॥ ২৫ ॥

bhakti-yoge bhakta pāya yāṅhāra darśana
through bhakti-yoga the devotee obtains whose sight
sūrya yena savigraha dekhe deva-gaṇa
the sun as in his form see the gods

25 Through *bhakti-yoga*, the path of devotion, the devotees obtain the sight of Him, just as the gods see the sun in his personal form.

জ্ঞান-যোগ-মার্গে তাঁরে ভজে যেই সব ।
ব্রহ্ম-আত্মরূপে তাঁরে করে অনুভব ॥ ২৬ ॥

jñāna-yoga-mārge tāṅre bhaje yei saba
of knowledge of yoga on the path Him worship who all
brahma-ātma-rūpe tāṅre kare anubhava
of Brahman of the Supersoul in the form Him they realize

26 Those who worship Him on the paths of knowledge and yoga realize Him as Brahman and as the Supersoul.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān's eternal form (*nitya-vigraha*) cannot be seen with the material senses or by the efforts of knowledge. Only devotees, through *bhakti-yoga*, that is, through *bhakti-rati*, the loving attraction of devotion, become fit to see it. Here is an example. The sun is an object that has a form. Ordinary eyes of flesh, or demoniac eyes, cannot see that form; but the divine eyes of the demigods pierce the network of the sun's rays and see it. Those who seek Bhagavān on the path of knowledge and on the path of yoga can follow only Brahman, the network of rays

of the eternal form, and Paramātmā, His part. They do not become fit to see the spiritual eternal form.

উপাসনা-ভেদে জানি ঈশ্বর-মহিমা ।
অতএব সূর্য্য তাঁর দিয়ে ত' উপমা ॥ ২৭ ॥

upāsanā-bhede jāni īśvara-mahimā
of worship by the differences one knows of the Lord the greatness
ataeva sūrya tāṅra diye ta' upamā
therefore of the sun to Him I give indeed the comparison

27 One comes to know the greatness of the Lord according to the different kinds of worship. That is why I compare Him to the sun.

(1) Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are one, yet differ in Their pastimes —

সেই নারায়ণ কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ অভেদ ।
একই বিগ্রহ, কিন্তু আকার-বিভেদ ॥ ২৮ ॥

sei nārāyaṇa kṛṣṇera svarūpa abheda
that Nārāyaṇa of Kṛṣṇa His own form non-different
ekai vigraha, kintu ākāra-vibheda
one and the same form but in shape difference

28 That Nārāyaṇa is non-different from Kṛṣṇa's own form. They are one and the same divine form (*vigraha*), but Their appearance differs.

ইঁহো ত' দ্বিভুজ, তিঁহো ধরে চারি হাথ ।
ইঁহো বেণু ধরে, তিঁহো চক্রাদিক সাথ ॥ ২৯ ॥

iṅho ta' dvi-bhuja, tiṅho dhare cāri hātha
this one indeed two-armed that one has four arms
iṅho veṇu dhare, tiṅho cakrādika sātha
this one the flute holds that one the disc and others with

29 Kṛṣṇa has two arms, and Nārāyaṇa has four. Kṛṣṇa holds the flute, and Nārāyaṇa holds the disc and His other emblems.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.14.14)*

নারায়ণস্ত্বং ন হি সর্ব্বদেহিনা-
মাত্মাস্যধীশাখিললোকসাক্ষী ।
নারায়ণোঽঙ্গং নরভূ-জলায়না-
ত্তচ্চাপি সত্যং ন তবৈব মায়া ॥ ৩০ ॥

nārāyaṇas tvaṁ na hi sarva-dehinām
Nārāyaṇa You not indeed of all embodied beings
ātmāsy adhīśākhila-loka-sākṣī
the Self You are O Lord of all worlds the witness
nārāyaṇo 'ṅgaṁ nara-bhū-jalāyanāt
Nārāyaṇa Your portion of Nara born the water as resting place
tac cāpi satyaṁ na tavaiva māyā
that and also true not Your indeed māyā

30 "O Lord, are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are the Self of all embodied beings and the witness of all the worlds. The one called Nārāyaṇa because His resting place is the water born of Nara is Your portion. And that portion too is real; it is not Your māyā." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.14.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Adhīśa, Supreme Lord, You are the witness of all the worlds. You are the Self of all embodied beings, that is, what is dearest to them; are You not, then, my father Nārāyaṇa? The water born of Nara is called *nāra*, and He whose resting place (*ayana*) is in it is Nārāyaṇa. He is Your *aṅga*, that is, Your part. None of Your parts — Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Kṣīrodaśāyī and Garbhodaśāyī — is subject to *māyā*: They are the masters of *māyā*, the supreme Truth beyond *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.
Brahmā stole the calves, then came to understand the truth about Śrī Kṛṣṇa and offered Him praise; this is one of the verses of that prayer.

adhīśa (O Adhīśa [Lord, endowed with majesty greater than that of the three *puruṣa-avatāras*]!) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** (are Nārāyaṇa (He from whom comes the movement [*ayana*], that is, the activity, of *nāra*)) **sarva-dehinām** (of all the embodied [of all living beings]) **ātmā** (the Self; [and so]) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** ((He whose shelter [*ayana*] is *nāra*, that is, the totality of *jīvas*:

the third *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Ocean of Milk)) **asi na hi** (are You not?) **akhila-loka-sākṣī** (the witness of all the worlds [the indwelling Lord of the aggregate [of *jīvas*]]) **tvam** (You) **nārāyaṇaḥ** ((He who knows [*ayase*] *nāra*: the second *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Garbhodaka)) **nara-bhū-jalāyanāt** ([because His shelter is the *arthas*, that is, the twenty-four elements that arose from Nara, the Paramātmā, and also the water born of Nara]) **nārāyaṇaḥ** (Nārāyaṇa [that celebrated first *puruṣa-avatāra*, who abides in the Kāraṇodaka] —) **saḥ api** (He too) **tava aṅgam** (is Your *aṅga* [part]) **tat ca api satyam** (And this too is true), **na tava eva māyā** (and not at all *māyā* [not transient, like what belongs to *māyā*]).

(Even when You descend as an avatāra, *māyā* cannot touch Your spiritual body. O Kṛṣṇa, You are the original Nārāyaṇa, and the Puruṣa and the other avatāras are Your parts; You alone are the whole. These avatāras are limbs (*aṅgas*), and You are the possessor of the limbs (*aṅgī*) — such is my conviction.)

Explanation of the verse —

শিশু বৎস হরি' ব্রহ্মা করি' অপরাধ ।
অপরাধ ক্ষমাইতে মাগেন প্রসাদ ॥ ৩১ ॥

śiśu vatsa hari' brahmā kari' aparādha
the boys the calves having stolen Brahmā having committed offense
aparādha kṣamāite māgena prasāda
the offense to have forgiven begs mercy

31 Brahmā had offended Kṛṣṇa by stealing the cowherd boys and the calves. To have his offense forgiven, he begged for mercy:

*Since Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa, all the *puruṣa-avatāras* are contained in Him —*

তোমার নাভিপদ্ম হৈতে আমার জন্মোদয় ।
তুমি পিতা-মাতা, আমি তোমার তনয় ॥ ৩২ ॥

tomāra nābhi-padma haite āmāra janmodaya
Your navel lotus from my birth
tumi pitā-mātā, āmi tomāra tanaya
You father mother I Your son

32 "I was born from the lotus of Your navel. You are my father and mother, and I am Your son.

পিতা মাতা বালকের না লয় অপরাধ ।
অপরাধ ক্ষম, মোরে করহ প্রসাদ ॥ ৩৩ ॥

pitā mātā bālakera nā laya aparādha
father mother of a child not take offense
aparādha kṣama, more karaha prasāda
the offense forgive to me show mercy

33 A father and mother do not take offense at what their child does. Forgive my offense and be merciful to me."

কৃষ্ণ কহেন — ব্রহ্মা, তোমার পিতা নারায়ণ ।
আমি গোপ, তুমি কৈছে আমার নন্দন ॥ ৩৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa kahena — brahmā, tomāra pitā nārāyaṇa
Kṛṣṇa says Brahmā your father Nārāyaṇa
āmi gopa, tumi kaiche āmāra nandana
I a cowherd you how My son

34 Kṛṣṇa said, "Brahmā, your father is Nārāyaṇa. I am a cowherd boy. How can you be My son?"

The first proof —

ব্রহ্মা বলেন, তুমি কি না হও নারায়ণ ।
তুমি নারায়ণ — শুন তাহার কারণ ॥ ৩৫ ॥

brahmā balena, tumi ki nā hao nārāyaṇa
Brahmā says You (question) not are Nārāyaṇa
tumi nārāyaṇa — śuna tāhāra kāraṇa
You Nārāyaṇa hear of that the reason

35 Brahmā said, “Are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are Nārāyaṇa — hear the reason why.

প্রাকৃতাপ্রাকৃত-সৃষ্ট্যে যত জীবরূপ ।
তাহার যে আত্মা তুমি মূল-স্বরূপ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

prākṛtāprākṛta-sṛṣṭye yata jīva-rūpa
in the material and spiritual creation as many as living beings' forms
tāhāra ye ātmā tumi mūla-svarūpa
their that Self You the original being

36 You are the Self of all the living beings in the material and the spiritual creation. You are their original source.

Anubhāṣya.
All the various things that have arisen from *prakṛti* through the modes are material (*prākṛta*). There are also the eternal varieties of spiritual *vilāsa*, which the modes cannot disturb; this is the transcendental (*aprākṛta*) creation. The hosts of liberated *jīvas* who belong to the transcendental manifestation are devoted to serving Kṛṣṇa. The conditioned *jīvas* are subject to time, are under the sway of the three modes and belong to the material creation. The liberated *jīvas* of the transcendental manifestation are always engaged in serving Kṛṣṇa, while the material *jīvas* are always bound to taste happiness and distress. Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original *svarūpa* of both the liberated and the conditioned *jīvas*. From His marginal potency (*taṭastha-śakti*) come various *jīvas*; some are turned toward service and others away from it, and all abide in various forms. When liberated, the *jīva* serves Bhagavān in the transcendental kingdom: in the five different *rasas* he abides under the protection of the *āśraya* (the shelter). In the kingdom of enjoyment, however, he is gripped by ignorance (*avidyā*): he thinks himself the enjoyer and sees in other things a “woman” (*yoṣid-buddhi*), that is, an object to enjoy. Both kinds of *jīvas* are manifestations of the transformation of the *taṭastha-śakti*; both depend on the Possessor of potency.

পৃথ্বী যৈছে ঘটকুলের কারণ আশ্রয় ।
জীবের নিদান তুমি, তুমি সর্ব্বাশ্রয় ॥ ৩৭ ॥

pṛthvī yaiche ghaṭa-kulera kāraṇa āśraya
the earth as of pots of the multitude the cause the shelter
jīvera nidāna tumi, tumi sarvāśraya
of the souls the origin You You the shelter of all

37 Just as the earth is the cause and the shelter of all pots, so You are the origin of all souls. You are the shelter of all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The material (*prākṛta*) creation lies within the bounds of *māyā*, *prakṛti*. “Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intelligence and false ego — these are the eight divisions of My separated *prakṛti*. This is the lower…” (*Bhagavad-gītā* 7.4–5). According to these words of the *Gītā*, all of it belongs to *māyā*, that is, is material: both the subtle world — mind, intelligence and false ego — and the five great elements beginning with earth. The pure *jīva* and the spiritual world are transcendental (*aprākṛta*). There are two worlds, the material and the transcendental, and two kinds of *jīvas*, the conditioned and the pure; You are the Self of them all, and therefore their original *svarūpa*. Earth is the cause and shelter of all pots; so too You alone are the *nidāna* of the *jīvas*, that is, their cause and shelter.

Anubhāṣya.

All-pervading clay is the material cause of the various pots it pervades. So too from Bhagavān, nondual knowledge, all the hosts of *jīvas* are eternally manifest, like pots. Bhagavān, the cause of all causes, always abides [in them] as the cause of the *jīvas*. The Śruti “The eternal among the eternal, the conscious among the conscious”[0] shows that the shelter of all that exists is the Supreme Truth.

The Viśiṣṭādvaitins define the subject of Vedānta like this. The *jīva*, the possessor of the subtle and gross bodies, is seen in three states. So too the spiritual and the material worlds appear in two states, separately from Bhagavān's *svarūpa*, and so establish His nonduality endowed with distinguishing features. The spiritual world is full of Bhagavān's associates, and the material world is the field of enjoyment for the conditioned *jīvas*, who have turned away from Bhagavān. Bhagavān's internal potency is the cause of the variety of His retinue;

His external potency has created the world born of the material modes. The material world is the gross, external part of Bhagavān's body, and the world of *jīvas* the subtle part of His body. Bhagavān is the possessor (*aṅgī*) of both kinds of parts. Gauḍīya philosophy (*Gauḍīya-darśana*) has established inconceivable oneness and difference (*acintya-bhedābheda*), present at once in the relation of cause and effect: between the Possessor of His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) and the two worlds, which are transformations of the spiritual and the non-spiritual potencies.

‘নার’ শব্দে কহে সর্ব্বজীবের নিচয়।
‘অয়ন’ শব্দেতে কহে তাহার আশ্রয় ॥ ৩৮ ॥

‘nāra’ śabde kahe sarva-jīvera nicaya
nāra by the word is meant of all living beings the aggregate
‘ayana’ śabdete kahe tāhāra āśraya
ayana by the word is meant their shelter

38 The word *nāra* means the aggregate of all living beings, and the word *ayana* means their shelter.

অতএব তুমি হও মূল নারায়ণ।
এই এক হেতু, শুন দ্বিতীয় কারণ ॥ ৩৯ ॥

ataeva tumi hao mūla nārāyaṇa
therefore You are the original Nārāyaṇa
ei eka hetu, śuna dvitīya kāraṇa
this one reason hear the second reason

39 Therefore You are the original Nārāyaṇa. That is the first reason; now hear the second.

The second proof —

জীবের ঈশ্বর — পুরুষাদি অবতার।
তাঁহা সবা হৈতে তোমার ঐশ্বর্য্য অপার ॥ ৪০ ॥

jīvera īśvara — puruṣādi avatāra
of the living beings the lords the Puruṣa and other avatāras
tāṅhā sabā haite tomāra aiśvarya apāra
Them all than Your opulence boundless

40 The lords of the living beings are the Puruṣa and the other avatāras. Your opulence is boundlessly greater than Theirs.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The Puruṣa and the other avatāras" are the three *puruṣa-avatāras*: Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī.

অতএব অধীশ্বর তুমি সর্ব্বপিতা ।
তোমার শক্তিতে তাঁরা জগৎ-রক্ষিতা ॥ ৪১ ॥

ataeva adhīśvara tumi sarva-pitā
therefore the supreme Lord You the father of all
tomāra śaktite tāṅrā jagat-rakṣitā
by Your potency They of the world protectors

41 Therefore You are the supreme Lord, the father of all. It is by Your potency that They protect the world.

নারের অয়ন যাতে করহ পালন ।
অতএব হও তুমি মূল নারায়ণ ॥ ৪২ ॥

nārera ayana yāte karaha pālana
of the nāras the shelters since You do protection
ataeva hao tumi mūla nārāyaṇa
therefore are You the original Nārāyaṇa

42 Since You protect Those who are the shelter of the living beings, You are the original Nārāyaṇa.

The third proof —

তৃতীয় কারণ শুন শ্রীভগবান্ ।
অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ড বহু বৈকুণ্ঠাদি ধাম ॥ ৪৩ ॥

tṛtīya kāraṇa śuna śrī-bhagavān
the third reason hear O Lord
ananta brahmāṇḍa bahu vaikuṇṭhādi dhāma
countless universes many Vaikuṇṭha and other abodes

43 O Lord, hear the third reason. There are countless universes and many abodes such as Vaikuṇṭha.

ইথে যত জীব, তার ত্রৈকালিক কর্ম্ম ।
তাহা দেখ, সাক্ষী তুমি, জান সব মর্ম্ম ॥ ৪৪ ॥

ithe yata jīva, tāra trai-kālika karma
in them as many as beings their of the three times deeds
tāhā dekha, sākṣī tumi, jāna saba marma
that You see the witness You You know of all the essence

44 You see the deeds of all the beings in them, past, present and future. You are the witness, and You know the inner meaning of everything.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ithe (in them) means in the material multitudes of universes and in the transcendental abodes, Vaikuṇṭha and the rest. You are the one witness, that is, the seer, of all the deeds of the conditioned and the pure *jīvas* — past, future and present.

তোমার দর্শনে সর্ব্ব জগতের স্থিতি ।
তুমি না দেখিলে কার নাহি স্থিতি গতি ॥ ৪৫ ॥

tomāra darśane sarva jagatera sthiti
by Your glance of all the worlds the existence
tumi nā dekhile kāra nāhi sthiti gati
You not if You look of anyone there is not rest movement

45 All the worlds exist by Your glance. If You did not look upon them, no one could either stay or move.

নারের অয়ন যাতে কর দরশন ।
তাহাতেও হও তুমি মূল নারায়ণ ॥ ৪৬ ॥

nārera ayana yāte kara daraśana
of the nāras the course since You do seeing
tāhāteo hao tumi mūla nārāyaṇa
by that too are You the original Nārāyaṇa

46 Since You see the course of all living beings, for this reason too You are the original Nārāyaṇa.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Yāte means “because”: because You see the *jīvas*, You are Nārāyaṇa, the shelter (*ayana*) of *nāra*. Brahmā establishes by three arguments that Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa. First: Kṛṣṇa is the *nidāna* (cause) and shelter of all *jīvas*, and therefore He is the original Nārāyaṇa. Second: the Lord of all *jīvas* is the Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Puruṣa; the Self of the aggregate *jīva*, that is, of Hiraṇyagarbha, is the Garbhodaśāyī Puruṣa; and the indwelling Lord, the Self of the individual *jīva*, is the Kṣīrodaśāyī Puruṣa. These three Puruṣas and Their avatāras receive Their power from Kṛṣṇa; He is its original source and thus the shelter of *nāra*, and therefore He is the original Nārāyaṇa. Third: in countless universes, in Vaikuṇṭha and in the other abodes, Kṛṣṇa is the witness of the deeds of the conditioned and the pure *jīvas* in all three times; thus He is the shelter of *nāra*, and therefore the original Nārāyaṇa.

কৃষ্ণ কহেন — ব্রহ্মা, তোমার না বুঝি বচন ।
জীব-হৃদি, জলে বৈসে সেই নারায়ণ ॥ ৪৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa kahena — brahmā, tomāra nā bujhi vacana
Kṛṣṇa says Brahmā your not I understand words
jīva-hṛdi, jale vaise sei nārāyaṇa
in the heart of beings on the water resides that Nārāyaṇa

47 Kṛṣṇa said, “Brahmā, I do not understand your words. Nārāyaṇa is He who resides in the hearts of the living beings and on the waters.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Jīva-hṛdi means in the heart of the individual and of the aggregate *jīva*. *Jale* (in the water) means in the Kāraṇābdhi, the Garbhodaka and the Kṣīrodaka.

ব্রহ্মা কহে — জলে জীবে যেই নারায়ণ ।
সে সব তোমার অংশ, — এ সত্য বচন ॥ ৪৮ ॥

brahmā kahe — jale jīve yei nārāyaṇa
Brahmā says on the water in the beings who Nārāyaṇa
se saba tomāra aṁśa, — e satya vacana
They all Your portions this true word

48 Brahmā said, "The Nārāyaṇa who lies on the waters and dwells in the living beings — all these are Your portions. This is the truth."

*The marks of the three *puruṣa-avatāras* —*

কারণাব্ধি-গর্ভোদক-ক্ষীরোদকশায়ী ।
মায়াদ্বারা সৃষ্টি করে, তাতে সব মায়ী ॥ ৪৯ ॥

kāraṇābdhi-garbhodaka-kṣīrodaka-śāyī
in the Causal Ocean the Garbha Ocean the Ocean of Milk lying
māyā-dvārā sṛṣṭi kare, tāte saba māyī
through māyā creation do therefore all wielders of māyā

49 Kāraṇodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī create through māyā; therefore They are all called wielders of māyā (*māyī*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Tāte saba māyī: because these three Puruṣas create through *māyā*, They are *māyī*, that is, the masters of *māyā*.

সেই তিন জলশায়ী সর্ব্ব-অন্তর্য্যামী ।
ব্রহ্মাণ্ডবৃন্দের আত্মা যে পুরুষ-নামী ॥ ৫০ ॥

sei tina jala-śāyī sarva-antaryāmī
those three lying on the waters dwelling within all
brahmāṇḍa-vṛndera ātmā ye puruṣa-nāmī
of the universes multitude the Self who named Puruṣa

50 These three Lords who lie on the waters dwell within all. The one named the Puruṣa is the Self of all the universes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Ye puruṣa-nāmī means “They whose name is Puruṣa.”

হিরণ্যগর্ভের আত্মা গর্ভোদকশায়ী ।
ব্যষ্টিজীব-অন্তর্য্যামী ক্ষীরোদকশায়ী ॥ ৫১ ॥

hiraṇya-garbhera ātmā garbhodaka-śāyī
of Hiraṇyagarbha the Self Garbhodakaśāyī
vyaṣṭi-jīva-antaryāmī kṣīrodaka-śāyī
of the individual being the indwelling Lord Kṣīrodakaśāyī

51 Garbhodakaśāyī is the Self of Hiraṇyagarbha, and Kṣīrodakaśāyī is the indwelling Lord of each individual being.

এ সভার দর্শনে ত’ আছে মায়াগন্ধ ।
তুরীয় কৃষ্ণের নাহি মায়ার সম্বন্ধ ॥ ৫২ ॥

e sabhāra darśane ta’ āche māyā-gandha
of these all in the glance indeed there is of māyā a trace
turīya kṛṣṇera nāhi māyāra sambandha
the fourth Kṛṣṇa's there is not with māyā connection

52 Because all these Lords cast Their glance upon māyā, a trace of māyā is associated with Them. But Kṛṣṇa, the fourth (*turīya*), has no connection with māyā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hiraṇyagarbha is the aggregate *jīva*; his indwelling Lord is Garbhodakaśāyī. The indwelling Lord of the *vyaṣṭi*, that is, of each separate *jīva*, is the Puruṣa Kṣīrodakaśāyī. The Puruṣa beyond these three Puruṣas is *turīya*, that is, the fourth. He is Kṛṣṇacandra's *vilāsa-mūrti*, Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma; in Him there is not even a trace of *māyā*.

*(from the *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.15.16)*

বিরাট্ হিরণ্যগর্ভশ্চ কারণং চেত্যুপাধয়ঃ ।
ঈশস্য যৎ ত্রিভির্হীনং তুরীয়ং তৎ প্রচক্ষতে ॥ ৫৩ ॥

virāṭ hiraṇya-garbhaś ca
Virāṭ Hiraṇyagarbha and
kāraṇaṁ cety upādhayaḥ
the Cause and thus designations
īśasya yat tribhir hīnaṁ
of the Lord what of the three free
turīyaṁ tat pracakṣate
the fourth that they call

53 "Virāṭ, Hiraṇyagarbha and the Cause are designations of the Lord. That which is free of these three is called the fourth (*turīya*)." (Śrīdhara Svāmī, commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.15.16)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Virāṭ, Hiraṇyagarbha and Kāraṇa are all designations (*upādhis*) connected with *māyā*. The truth free of *upādhis* is *turīya*, the fourth.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrīdhara Svāmī quotes this verse in his commentary to explain the word *turīya*.

virāṭ ([the gross]), **hiraṇya-garbhaḥ** ([the subtle]) **ca** (and) **kāraṇam** ([ignorance, or *prakṛti*] —) **iti** ([these]) **īśasya** (of the Lord [the *puruṣa-avatāra*, creator of the *mahat-tattva*]) **upādhayaḥ** (are the *upādhis* [particular manifestations]) **yat** (That which) **tribhiḥ** (by [these] three [*upādhis*]) **hīnam** (is untouched [not connected with them]), **tat** ([that [state]) **turīyam** (the fourth [Vaikuṇṭha, beyond the three Puruṣas]) **pracakṣate** (they call).

যদ্যপি তিনের মায়া লইয়া ব্যবহার ।
তথাপি তৎস্পর্শ নাহি, সভে মায়া-পার ॥ ৫৪ ॥

yadyapi tinera māyā laiyā vyavahāra
although of the three māyā with dealings
tathāpi tat-sparśa nāhi, sabhe māyā-pāra
still its touch there is not all beyond māyā

54 Although these three deal with māyā, māyā does not touch Them. All of Them are beyond māyā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hiraṇyagarbha and the rest — the aggregate and the individual *jīvas* — are subject to *māyā*. The three Puruṣas mentioned have dealings with *māyā*, yet They are beyond it. They are the truth that rules over *māyā*: They glance at *māyā* but do not touch it.

*To descend into the material world and remain beyond it — this is the very nature of Bhagavān — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.11.38)*

এতদীশনমীশস্য প্রকৃতিস্থোঽপি তদ্গুণৈঃ ।
ন যুজ্যতে সদাত্মস্থৈর্যথা বুদ্ধিস্তদাশ্রয়া ॥ ৫৫ ॥

etad īśanam īśasya
this the divinity of the Lord
prakṛti-stho 'pi tad-guṇaiḥ
in material nature situated though by its qualities
na yujyate sadātma-sthair
not is touched always abiding in Him
yathā buddhis tad-āśrayā
as the intelligence taking shelter of Him

55 "This is the divinity of the Lord: although He is within material nature, He is never touched by its qualities, though they always rest in Him. In the same way the intelligence of those who take shelter of Him remains untouched by them." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.11.38)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord's lordship consists in just this: He abides in *prakṛti* yet does not come under the sway of its modes. When the intelligence of a *jīva* bound by *māyā* takes shelter of the Lord (*Īśa*), it does not join with the modes of *māyā* even when near *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa returned to His palace in the city of Dvārakā and spent His time with the queens. There was not even a trace of *māyā* in His conduct, and Śrī Sūta spoke

of it like this:

tad-āśrayā ([sheltered in Śrī Bhagavān, as is that of the great devotees]) **buddhiḥ** (intelligence) **yathā** (just as [though it has somehow come to be in *prakṛti*] [**na yujyate**] does not become bound [to the modes], so [He too]. Or else, by contrast): **tad-āśrayā** ([resting on *prakṛti*]) **buddhiḥ** (intelligence [the knowledge of the *jīva*]) **yathā** (just as [**yujyate**] becomes bound, so [He] **na** — does not [become bound]) **prakṛti-sthaḥ api** (even while abiding in *prakṛti* [being in the world made of the three modes]), **sadā** (always) **ātma-sthaiḥ** (abiding in Him) **tad-guṇaiḥ** (by its modes) **na yujyate** (is not bound [does not become attached to the material modes]) **etat** ([Just] this) **īśasya** (of the Lord [Bhagavān, all-powerful and beyond *māyā*]) **īśanam** (is the lordship [*aiśvarya*]).

সেই তিন জনের তুমি পরম আশ্রয় ।
তুমি মূলনারায়ণ — ইথে কি সংশয় ॥ ৫৬ ॥

sei tina janera tumi parama āśraya
of those three persons You the supreme shelter
tumi mūla nārāyaṇa — ithe ki saṁśaya
You the original Nārāyaṇa in this what doubt

56 "You are the supreme shelter of these three. You are the original Nārāyaṇa — what doubt can there be?

Anubhāṣya.

For "those three" — Kṣīrodakaśāyī, Garbhodakaśāyī and Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu — You are the supreme shelter. Their source is Your *vilāsa-mūrti*, the *catur-vyūha*: Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. From Saṅkarṣaṇa, in the Causal Waters, appears the first *puruṣa-avatāra*, the creator of the *mahat-tattva*, Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī; from Pradyumna, the second *puruṣa-avatāra*, Garbhodakaśāyī; and from Aniruddha, the third *puruṣa-avatāra*, Kṣīrodakaśāyī. Once They appear, They remain under the shelter of Nārāyaṇa alone.

সেই তিনের অংশী পরব্যোম-নারায়ণ ।
তেঁহ তোমার প্রকাশ, তুমি মূল-নারায়ণ ॥ ৫৭ ॥

sei tinera aṁśī paravyoma-nārāyaṇa
of those three the source of the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa
teṅha tomāra prakāśa, tumi mūla-nārāyaṇa
He Your manifestation You the original Nārāyaṇa

57 The source of these three is Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky. He is Your manifestation, and You are the original Nārāyaṇa."[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Aṁśī is the One of whom [another] is a part. The Nārāyaṇa of Paravyoma is the *aṁśī* of the *puruṣa-avatāras*. He is Your secondary manifestation (*prakāśa*) in the form of *vilāsa*.

অতএব ব্রহ্মবাক্যে পরব্যোম-নারায়ণ ।
তেঁহো কৃষ্ণের বিলাস — এই তত্ত্ব-বিবরণ ॥ ৫৮ ॥

ataeva brahma-vākye paravyoma-nārāyaṇa
therefore in Brahmā's words of the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa
teṅho kṛṣṇera vilāsa — ei tattva-vivaraṇa
He of Kṛṣṇa the pastime form this of the truth the explanation

58 Thus, according to Brahmā's words, Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is a pastime form (*vilāsa*) of Kṛṣṇa. This is the explanation of the truth.

এই শ্লোক তত্ত্ব-লক্ষণ ভাগবত-সার ।
পরিভাষা-রূপে ইহার সর্ব্বত্রাধিকার ॥ ৫৯ ॥

ei śloka tattva-lakṣaṇa bhāgavata-sāra
this verse of the truth the definition of the Bhāgavata the essence
paribhāṣā-rūpe ihāra sarvatrādhikāra
of a governing rule in the form its everywhere authority

59 This verse defines the truth and is the essence of the Bhāgavatam. As a governing rule (*paribhāṣā*), it holds authority everywhere.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Paribhāṣā means a [defining] *sūtra*. *Sarvatrādhikāra*: you will find this mark everywhere in the *Bhāgavatam*.

Anubhāṣya.
"This verse" is the verse *nārāyaṇas tvam…* quoted above as number 30.

ব্রহ্ম, আত্মা, ভগবান্ — কৃষ্ণের বিহার ।
এ অর্থ না জানি' মূর্খ অর্থ করে আর ॥ ৬০ ॥

brahma, ātmā, bhagavān — kṛṣṇera vihāra
Brahman the Supersoul Bhagavān of Kṛṣṇa manifestations
e artha nā jāni' mūrkha artha kare āra
this meaning not knowing fools meaning make another

60 Brahman, the Supersoul and Bhagavān are manifestations of Kṛṣṇa. Not knowing this meaning, fools interpret the verse otherwise.

Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa is a part of Nārāyaṇa and Nārāyaṇa the whole —

অবতারী নারায়ণ, কৃষ্ণ অবতার ।
তেঁহ চতুর্ভুজ, ইঁহ মনুষ্য-আকার ॥ ৬১ ॥

avatārī nārāyaṇa, kṛṣṇa avatāra
the source of avatāras Nārāyaṇa Kṛṣṇa an avatāra
teṅha catur-bhuja, iṅha manuṣya-ākāra
He four-armed this one of human form

61 They say that Nārāyaṇa is the source of the avatāras and Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra, since Nārāyaṇa has four arms and Kṛṣṇa has a human form.

এইমতে নানারূপ করে পূর্ব্বপক্ষ ।
তাহারে নির্জ্জিতে ভাগবত-পদ্য দক্ষ ॥ ৬২ ॥

ei-mate nānā-rūpa kare pūrva-pakṣa
in this way of various kinds make objections
tāhāre nirjite bhāgavata-padya dakṣa
them to defeat of the Bhāgavata a verse is able

62 In this way they raise objections of many kinds. A verse of the Bhāgavatam is able to defeat them:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Vihāra means *vihāra* in the form of manifestations (*prakāśas*). Fools do not understand this meaning and interpret otherwise, for example: “Nārāyaṇa is the source of the avatāras, and Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra.” When such conclusions are put forward as a *pūrvapakṣa* (an opponent's thesis), the verses of the *Bhāgavatam* refute them with special skill.

*(2) Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are different — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.11)*

বদন্তি তত্তত্ত্ববিদস্তত্ত্বং যজ্‌জ্ঞানমদ্বয়ম্ ।
ব্রহ্মেতি পরমাত্মেতি ভগবানিতি শব্দ্যতে ॥ ৬৩ ॥

vadanti tat tattva-vidas
declare that the knowers of the Truth
tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam
the Truth which knowledge non-dual
brahmeti paramātmeti
Brahman as the Supersoul as
bhagavān iti śabdyate
Bhagavān as is named

63 “The knowers of the Truth declare that the Truth is non-dual knowledge. It is named Brahman, the Supersoul and Bhagavān.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.2.11)

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 2.11.

শুন ভাই, এ শ্লোকার্থ করহ বিচার ।
এক মুখ্যতত্ত্ব, তিন তাহার প্রচার ॥ ৬৪ ॥

śuna bhāi, e ślokārtha karaha vicāra
hear brothers of this verse the meaning make consideration
eka mukhya-tattva, tina tāhāra pracāra
one principal Truth three its manifestations

64 Listen, brothers, and consider the meaning of this verse. There is one principal Truth, and It has three manifestations.

অদ্বয়জ্ঞান তত্ত্ববস্তু কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ ।
ব্রহ্ম, আত্মা, ভগবান্, — তিন তাঁর রূপ ॥ ৬৫ ॥

advaya-jñāna tattva-vastu kṛṣṇera svarūpa
non-dual knowledge the Absolute Reality of Kṛṣṇa the own form
brahma, ātmā, bhagavān, — tina tāṅra rūpa
Brahman the Supersoul Bhagavān three His forms

65 The non-dual knowledge, the Absolute Reality, is Kṛṣṇa's own form. Brahman, the Supersoul and Bhagavān are His three forms.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In this verse the word *advaya-jñāna* (nondual knowledge) means the original Truth, Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa*.

এই শ্লোকের অর্থে তুমি হৈলা নির্ব্বচন ।
আর এক শুন ভাগবতের বচন ॥ ৬৬ ॥

ei ślokera arthe tumi hailā nirvacana
of this verse by the meaning you became speechless
āra eka śuna bhāgavatera vacana
another one hear of the Bhāgavata statement

66 The meaning of this verse has left you speechless. Now hear another statement of the Bhāgavatam.

*Refuting the view that Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra or a part — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.28)*

এতে চাংশকলাঃ পুংসঃ কৃষ্ণস্তু ভগবান্ স্বয়ম্ ।
ইন্দ্রারিব্যাকুলং লোকং মৃড়য়ন্তি যুগে যুগে ॥ ৬৭ ॥

ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ
these and portions parts of the Puruṣa
kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam
Kṛṣṇa but Bhagavān Himself
indrāri-vyākulaṁ lokaṁ
by the enemies of Indra troubled the world
mṛḍayanti yuge yuge
make happy in age after age

67 "All these are portions and parts of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring relief to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.3.28)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and the others are parts (*aṁśas*) or parts of parts (*kalās*) of the *puruṣa-avatāra*. But Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. These avatāras protect the world, oppressed by the Daityas (demons), in age after age.

Anubhāṣya.
After listing Śrī Kṛṣṇa's avatāras, Śrī Sūta concludes with this verse.

ete ([the avatāras named before]) **puṁsaḥ** ([of the *puruṣa-avatāra*]) **aṁśa-kalāḥ** (are parts and *kalās* [parts of parts]) **kṛṣṇaḥ tu** (But Kṛṣṇa) **bhagavān svayam** (is Bhagavān Himself) **indrāri-vyākulam** ([These partial avatāras] [oppressed by the demons]) **lokam** ([the universe]) **yuge yuge** ([in every age, at the proper time]) **mṛḍayanti** ([make happy]).

সব অবতারের করি সামান্য-লক্ষণ ।
তার মধ্যে কৃষ্ণচন্দ্রের করিল গণন ॥ ৬৮ ॥

saba avatārera kari sāmānya-lakṣaṇa
of all avatāras having made general description
tāra madhye kṛṣṇa-candrera karila gaṇana
them among Kṛṣṇacandra made counting

68 After describing the general features of all the avatāras, Sūta counted Kṛṣṇacandra among Them.

তবে সূত গোসাঞি মনে পাঞা বড় ভয় ।
যাঁর যে লক্ষণ তাহা করিল নিশ্চয় ॥ ৬৯ ॥

tabe sūta gosāñi mane pāñā baḍa bhaya
then Sūta Gosāñi in the mind feeling great fear
yāṅra ye lakṣaṇa tāhā karila niścaya
of whom which characteristic that made determination

69 Then Sūta Gosvāmī grew very apprehensive and defined the distinctive characteristic of each.

অবতার সব — পুরুষের কলা-অংশ ।
স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্ব-অবতংস ॥ ৭০ ॥

avatāra saba — puruṣera kalā-aṁśa
the avatāras all of the Puruṣa parts portions
svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa sarva-avataṁsa
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa of all the crown

70 All the avatāras are parts and portions of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Lord Himself, the crown of all.

পূর্ব্বপক্ষ কহে — তোমার ভাল ত' ব্যাখ্যান ।
পরব্যোমে-নারায়ণ স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ॥ ৭১ ॥

pūrva-pakṣa kahe — tomāra bhāla ta' vyākhyāna
the opponent says your fine indeed explanation
paravyome-nārāyaṇa svayaṁ bhagavān
of the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa Himself Bhagavān

71 An opponent says, "A fine explanation you give! But Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky is the Supreme Lord Himself.

তেঁহ আসি' কৃষ্ণরূপে করেন অবতার ।
এই অর্থ শ্লোকে দেখি — কি আর বিচার ॥ ৭২ ॥

teṅha āsi' kṛṣṇa-rūpe karena avatāra
He coming in the form of Kṛṣṇa makes descent
ei artha śloke dekhi — ki āra vicāra
this meaning in the verse I see what more consideration

72 He comes and descends in the form of Kṛṣṇa. That is the meaning I see in the verse. What more is there to consider?"

(3) Refuting, by the rules of poetics, the view that Kṛṣṇa is a part of Nārāyaṇa

—

তারে কহে — কেনে কর কুতর্কানুমান ।
শাস্ত্রবিরুদ্ধার্থ কভু না হয় প্রমাণ ॥ ৭৩ ॥

tāre kahe — kene kara kutarkānumāna
to him one says why do you make of false logic inference
śāstra-viruddhārtha kabhu nā haya pramāṇa
contrary to scripture meaning ever not is proof

73 The answer to him is this: "Why do you draw inferences by false logic? A meaning that contradicts scripture can never be proof."

*(a rule of poetics, *Ekādaśī-tattva* 13)*

অনুবাদমনুক্ত্বা তু ন বিধেয়মুদীরয়েৎ ।
ন হ্যলব্ধাস্পদং কিঞ্চিৎ কুত্রচিৎ প্রতিতিষ্ঠতি ॥ ৭৪ ॥

anuvādam anuktvā tu
the subject without stating but
na vidheyam udīrayet
not the predicate one should utter
na hy alabdhāspadaṁ kiñcit
not for without a footing anything
kutracit pratitiṣṭhati
anywhere stands firm

74 "One should not state the predicate without first stating the subject, for nothing without a footing can stand firm anywhere." (Ekādaśī-tattva 13)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In poetics the unknown is called the *vidheya*, and the known the *anuvāda*. Take the sentence “This brāhmaṇa is learned.” Everyone knows that this man is a brāhmaṇa; so this is the *anuvāda*. Not everyone knows that the brāhmaṇa is learned; so this is the *vidheya*. If someone states the *vidheya* first without stating the *anuvāda*, his statement has nothing to rest on and cannot stand.

Anubhāṣya.

anuvādam (the *uddeśya*, that is, the known subject) **anuktvā** (without stating) **vidheyam** (the unknown subject) **na udīrayet** (one should not state) **hi** (for) **alabdhāspadam** (that which has not found a footing, its own place) **kiñcit** (anything) **kutracit** (anywhere) **na pratitiṣṭhati** (does not stand firm).

*The rule for using the *anuvāda* and the *vidheya* —*

অনুবাদ না কহিয়া না কহি বিধেয় ।
আগে অনুবাদ কহি, পশ্চাদ্বিধেয় ॥ ৭৫ ॥

anuvāda nā kahiyā nā kahi vidheya
the subject not having stated not one states the predicate
āge anuvāda kahi, paścād vidheya
first the subject one states after the predicate

75 One does not state the predicate without first stating the subject. First one states the subject, and then the predicate.

*Definition of the *anuvāda* and the *vidheya* —*

‘বিধেয়’ কহিয়ে তারে, যে বস্তু অজ্ঞাত ।
‘অনুবাদ’ কহি তারে, যেই হয় জ্ঞাত ॥ ৭৬ ॥

‘vidheya’ kahiye tāre, ye vastu ajñāta
predicate one calls that which thing unknown
‘anuvāda’ kahi tāre, yei haya jñāta
subject one calls that which is known

76 The predicate is what is not yet known, and the subject is what is already known.

An example —

যৈছে কহি, — এই বিপ্র পরম পণ্ডিত ।
বিপ্র — অনুবাদ, ইহার বিধেয় — পাণ্ডিত্য ॥ ৭৭ ॥

yaiche kahi, — ei vipra parama paṇḍita
as we say this brāhmaṇa great scholar
vipra — anuvāda, ihāra vidheya — pāṇḍitya
brāhmaṇa the subject his predicate learning

77 For example, we say, “This brāhmaṇa is a great scholar.” Here *brāhmaṇa* is the subject, and his learning is the predicate.

বিপ্র বলি’ জানি, তার পাণ্ডিত্য অজ্ঞাত ।
অতএব বিপ্র আগে, পাণ্ডিত্য পশ্চাৎ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

vipra bali’ jāni, tāra pāṇḍitya ajñāta
a brāhmaṇa as we know his learning unknown
ataeva vipra āge, pāṇḍitya paścāt
therefore brāhmaṇa first learning after

78 We know that he is a brāhmaṇa, but his learning is not known. Therefore *brāhmaṇa* comes first and his learning after.

*Explaining the verse *ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ…* by the rule of *anuvāda* and *vidheya*, or: Kṛṣṇa is the source of the avatāras —*

তৈছে ইঁহ অবতার, সব তাঁর জ্ঞাত ।
কার অবতার — এই বস্তু অবিজ্ঞাত ॥ ৭৯ ॥

taiche iṅha avatāra, saba tāṅra jñāta
so here avatāras all They known
kāra avatāra — ei vastu avijñāta
whose avatāras this thing unknown

79 In the same way, the avatāras here are all known, but whose avatāras They are is not known.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Iha means “this one” (He). “His avatāras” is a known subject. But whose avatāras they are is not yet known.

‘এতে’ শব্দে অবতারের আগে অনুবাদ ।
‘পুরুষের অংশ’ পাছে বিধেয় সংবাদ ॥ ৮০ ॥

‘ete’ śabde avatārera āge anuvāda
“these” by the word of the avatāras first the subject
‘puruṣera aṁśa’ pāche vidheya saṁvāda
“portions of the Puruṣa” after of the predicate the statement

80 First the word *ete*, “these,” states the subject, the avatāras. Then the words “portions of the Puruṣa” state the predicate.

তৈছে কৃষ্ণ অবতার-ভিতরে হৈল জ্ঞাত ।
তাঁহার বিশেষ-জ্ঞান সেই অবিজ্ঞাত ॥ ৮১ ॥

taiche kṛṣṇa avatāra-bhitare haila jñāta
so Kṛṣṇa the avatāras among became known
tāṅhāra viśeṣa-jñāna sei avijñāta
His distinctive knowledge that unknown

81 In the same way, Kṛṣṇa was known as one among the avatāras, but His distinctive nature was not known.

অতএব ‘কৃষ্ণ’ শব্দ আগে অনুবাদ ।
‘স্বয়ং ভগবত্তা’ পিছে বিধেয় সংবাদ ॥ ৮২ ॥

ataeva ‘kṛṣṇa’ śabda āge anuvāda
therefore “Kṛṣṇa” the word first the subject
‘svayaṁ bhagavattā’ piche vidheya saṁvāda
“being the Lord Himself” after of the predicate the statement

82 Therefore the word *Kṛṣṇa* comes first as the subject, and after it the predicate states that He is the Supreme Lord Himself.

কৃষ্ণের স্বয়ং-ভগবত্তা — ইহা হৈল সাধ্য ।
স্বয়ং-ভগবানের কৃষ্ণত্ব হৈল বাধ্য ॥ ৮৩ ॥

kṛṣṇera svayaṁ-bhagavattā — ihā haila sādhya
Kṛṣṇa's being the Lord Himself this became the thing to be established
svayaṁ-bhagavānera kṛṣṇatva haila bādhya
of the Lord Himself being Kṛṣṇa became binding

83 Kṛṣṇa's being the Supreme Lord Himself is what must be established (*sādhya*); that the Supreme Lord Himself is Kṛṣṇa follows as a binding conclusion (*bādhya*).

Otherwise Sūta's words would contradict themselves —

কৃষ্ণ যদি অংশ হৈত, অংশী নারায়ণ ।
তবে বিপরীত হৈত সূতের বচন ॥ ৮৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa yadi aṁśa haita, aṁśī nārāyaṇa
Kṛṣṇa if a portion were the source Nārāyaṇa
tabe viparīta haita sūtera vacana
then reversed would be of Sūta the statement

84 If Kṛṣṇa were a portion and Nārāyaṇa the source, Sūta's statement would have been the reverse.

নারায়ণ অংশী যেই স্বয়ং-ভগবান্ ।
তেঁহ শ্রীকৃষ্ণ — ঐছে করি তা ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ৮৫ ॥

nārāyaṇa aṁśī yei svayaṁ-bhagavān
Nārāyaṇa the source who the Lord Himself
teṅha śrī-kṛṣṇa — aiche kari tā vyākhyāna
He Śrī Kṛṣṇa thus would make that explanation

85 He would have put it this way: "Nārāyaṇa, the source of the portions, the Supreme Lord Himself — He is Śrī Kṛṣṇa."

Freedom from the four defects is the mark and distinction of the words of liberated souls —

ভ্রম, প্রমাদ, বিপ্রলিপ্সা, করণাপাটব ৷
আর্ষ-বিজ্ঞবাক্যে নাহি দোষ এই সব ॥ ৮৬ ॥

bhrama, pramāda, vipralipsā, karaṇāpāṭava
error inattention the wish to cheat imperfect senses
ārṣa-vijña-vākye nāhi doṣa ei saba
of the sages wise in the words there are not faults these all

86 Error, inattention, the wish to cheat and imperfect senses — none of these faults are found in the words of the wise sages.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the verse *ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ…* the word *ete* (these) names the avatāras; this is its *anuvāda*. That they are parts of the *puruṣa-avatāra* was not known before, and this is stated next as the *vidheya*. In this verse Kṛṣṇa too is mentioned among the avatāras. But the special knowledge about Kṛṣṇa is not yet known, so a *vidheya* is needed. That is why the word "Kṛṣṇa" comes first, as the *anuvāda*, and its *vidheya* is that Kṛṣṇa is "Bhagavān Himself." This is what must be established here (*sādhya*): the reasoning must prove that Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Therefore the words *kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam* necessarily (*bādhya*) mean "Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself," and they can have no other meaning. If Nārāyaṇa were the whole and Kṛṣṇa the part, Sūta's words would stand in the reverse order: "Bhagavān Himself is Kṛṣṇa." But *ārṣa*, the wise sayings of the sages, are free from the four defects — *bhrama*, *pramāda*, *vipralipsā* and *karaṇāpāṭava*. That is why the text reads *kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam*. *Bhrama* is false knowledge; *pramāda*, inattention; *vipralipsā*, a mind distracted elsewhere; *karaṇāpāṭava*, the imperfection of the senses.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhrama is false knowledge of a thing, taking it to be what it is not, as when one takes a rope for a snake or mother-of-pearl for silver. **Pramāda** is inattention: one perceives, hears or says one thing as another. **Vipralipsā** is the desire to cheat. **Karaṇāpāṭava** is the imperfection of the senses. For example, the eye cannot see what is far away or make out what is tiny; in jaundice and other diseases the

perception of color (form) is distorted; and the ear cannot hear a sound from far away.

বিরুদ্ধার্থ কহ তুমি, কহিতে কর রোষ ।
তোমার অর্থে অবিমৃষ্টবিধেয়াংশ-দোষ ॥ ৮৭ ॥

viruddhārtha kaha tumi, kahite kara roṣa
a contradictory meaning speak you when told you show anger
tomāra arthe avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa-doṣa
in your meaning of the ill-considered predicate the fault

87 You give a contradictory meaning, and when this is pointed out you become angry. Your interpretation has the fault called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa*, an ill-placed predicate.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The defect called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* arises when the *vidheya* is stated before the *anuvāda*. *Avimṛṣṭa* means unconsidered.

Anubhāṣya.
Avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa. The *vidheyāṁśa* is the unknown subject. If it is not set forth as the main thing, the defect called *avimṛṣṭa-vidheyāṁśa* arises. Its other name is *vidheya-avimarśa*.

The meaning and definition of the words "Bhagavān Himself" —

যাঁর ভগবত্তা হৈতে অন্যের ভগবত্তা ।
'স্বয়ং ভগবান্' শব্দের তাহাতেই সত্তা ॥ ৮৮ ॥

yāṅra bhagavattā haite anyera bhagavattā
whose divinity from of others divinity
'svayaṁ bhagavān' śabdera tāhātei sattā
"the Lord Himself" of the words in Him alone application

88 The words "the Supreme Lord Himself" apply only to Him from whose divinity the others derive Theirs.

An example of the source of the avatāras and of the avatāras —

দীপ হৈতে যৈছে বহু দীপের জ্বলন ।
মূল এক দীপ তাহা করিয়ে গণন ॥ ৮৯ ॥

dīpa haite yaiche bahu dīpera jvalana
a lamp from as many lamps' lighting
mūla eka dīpa tāhā kariye gaṇana
the original one lamp that I count

89 When many lamps are lit from one lamp, I count that one as the original lamp.

Anubhāṣya.

Brahma-saṁhitā, Chapter 5, verse 46: “The flame of a lamp passes to another wick and itself becomes a lamp: it burns separately, yet has the same qualities as its source. In the same way He shines in the form of Viṣṇu. I worship Govinda, the original Puruṣa.”

All the *viṣṇu-tattvas* are like lamps: they are full of light and have the same qualities as the original Nārāyaṇa. Yet they are lit from the original lamp. The *viṣṇu-tattvas* are equal to Govinda in being light. But Viriñci (Brahmā) and Śambhu (Śiva) are not so, even though they too are *guṇa-avatāras*. Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī says: “Śambhu, however, is the seat of *tamas*. He is like a thin lamp flame mixed with soot, and so there is no such equality.”

তৈছে সব অবতারের কৃষ্ণ সে কারণ ।
আর এক শ্লোক শুন, কুব্যাখ্যা-খণ্ডন ॥ ৯০ ॥

taiche saba avatārera kṛṣṇa se kāraṇa
so of all the avatāras Kṛṣṇa He the cause
āra eka śloka śuna, kuvyākhyā-khaṇḍana
another one verse hear of false interpretations the refutation

90 In the same way, Kṛṣṇa is the cause of all the avatāras. Now hear another verse, which refutes false interpretations.

(4) By the marks of a Purāṇa too, the original shelter is not Nārāyaṇa but

*Kṛṣṇa — (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.10.1–2)*

অত্র সর্গো বিসর্গশ্চ স্থানং পোষণমূতয়ঃ ।
মন্বন্তরেশানুকথা নিরোধো মুক্তিরাশ্রয়ঃ ॥ ৯১ ॥

দশমস্য বিশুদ্ধ্যর্থং নবানামিহ লক্ষণম্ ।
বর্ণয়ন্তি মহাত্মানঃ শ্রুতেনার্থেন চাঞ্জসা ॥ ৯২ ॥

atra sargo visargaś ca
here primary creation secondary creation and
sthānaṁ poṣaṇam ūtayaḥ
maintenance protection the impetus for action
manvantareśānukathā
the reigns of the Manus of the Lord narrations
nirodho muktir āśrayaḥ
dissolution liberation the shelter
daśamasya viśuddhy-arthaṁ
of the tenth for clear knowledge
navānām iha lakṣaṇam
of the nine here the description
varṇayanti mahātmānaḥ
describe the great souls
śrutenārthena cāñjasā
by direct statement by implied meaning and plainly

91–92 "Here are described primary creation, secondary creation, maintenance, protection, the impetus for action, the reigns of the Manus, the narrations of the Lord, dissolution, liberation and the shelter. To make the tenth clearly known, the great souls describe the other nine here, plainly, by direct statement and by implied meaning." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.10.1–2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *Bhāgavatam* describes ten subjects: *sarga*, *visarga*, *sthāna*, *ūti*, *poṣaṇa*, the *manvantaras*, *īśa-kathā*, *nirodha*, *mukti* and *āśraya*. The tenth truth is *āśraya*, the shelter. To examine it in its purity, the great souls have

described the nine preceding marks: in some places through prayers and narratives, and in others through direct reasoning.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the Tenth Canto Śrī Kṛṣṇa is pointed out as the *āśraya-vigraha*, the form who is the shelter of all who seek shelter. I bow to that supreme abode and abode of the universe whose name is Śrī Kṛṣṇa. The meaning is this. In the world there are two truths: *āśraya*, the shelter, and *āśrita*, that which rests on the shelter. The original truth on which all the *āśrita-tattvas* rest is the *āśraya*. All the truths that exist by resting on it are *āśrita-tattvas*. Everything from *sarga* to *mukti* is *āśrita-tattva*. Thus the *puruṣa-avatāras* and all the avatāras who follow Them, all the potencies, and after them the worlds of *jīvas* and of matter — all of these rest on that shelter, on Kṛṣṇa. In its prayers and narratives the *Bhāgavatam* examines the *āśraya-tattva* partly indirectly, and in its direct teachings directly. Therefore one must know Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* and His three potencies.

Anubhāṣya.

Parīkṣit asked how the *rājasic* creations arose from the Vairāja Puruṣa. In answer Śukadeva speaks this verse at the start of his explanation of the *catuḥ-ślokī*, the four verses.

atra (here, in the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **sargaḥ** (the birth of the elements, the subtle elements, the senses and the intelligence) **visargaḥ** (the imbalance of the modes in Brahmā's creation) **sthānam** (maintenance [*sthiti*]. This is Bhagavān's victory: His excellence shows in the fact that everything created keeps within its bounds) **poṣaṇam** (His mercy to His devotees) **ūtayaḥ** (the desires that impel one to karma) **manvantara** (the *manvantaras*, that is, the *dharma* of goodness) **īśānukathāḥ** (the narratives of Hari's avatāras) **nirodhaḥ** (withdrawal: the world, together with the potencies, lies down to sleep following the Self) **muktiḥ** (abiding in the pure state) **āśrayaḥ** (the Parabrahman, the Paramātmā, the cause of creation, maintenance and dissolution).

These are the ten subjects.

Anubhāṣya.

mahātmānaḥ (the great souls, Vidura and others) **iha** (here, in the Purāṇa *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **daśamasya** (of the tenth, that is, of the *āśraya*) **viśuddhy-artham** (for clear knowledge, that is, knowledge of the truth) **navānām**

(of the nine [subjects]) **lakṣaṇam** (the nature) **śrutena** (by the word that names them directly) **añjasā** (directly) **arthena** (by the meaning) **varṇayanti** (describe).

1. *Sarga* — the arising of the five great elements, the five *tanmātras* (subtle elements), the ten senses, the mind, the *mahat-tattva* and false ego (*ahaṅkāra*), both in the form of the Virāṭ and in their own nature. 2. *Visarga* — Brahmā's creation of the moving and the unmoving. 3. *Sthiti* — Bhagavān's victory, His excellence over Brahmā, the creator, and over Śiva, the destroyer. 4. *Poṣaṇa* — Bhagavān's mercy to His devotees. 5. *Ūti* — the desires that impel one to karma. 6. *Manvantara* — the *dharma* followed by the *jīvas* in goodness. 7. *Īśa-kathā* — the narratives of Hari's avatāras and of the *bhāgavatas* (His devotees). 8. *Nirodha* — Hari enters His mystic sleep (*yoga-nidrā*) and lies down together with His potencies, the *upādhis*. 9. *Mukti* — the *jīva* gives up his gross and subtle forms and abides in the form of a pure *jīva* or of an associate of the Lord. 10. *Āśraya* — that celebrated Parabrahman and Paramātmā from whom creation and dissolution proceed and in whom the universe is manifest.

আশ্রয় জানিতে কহি এ নব পদার্থ ।
এ নবের উৎপত্তি-হেতু সেই আশ্রয়ার্থ ॥ ৯৩ ॥

āśraya jānite kahi e nava padārtha
the shelter to know I describe these nine categories
e navera utpatti-hetu sei āśrayārtha
of these nine of origin the cause that the meaning of shelter

93 I describe these nine categories so that the shelter may be known. The cause from which these nine arise — that is what *shelter* means.

কৃষ্ণ এক সর্ব্বাশ্রয়, কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্বধাম ।
কৃষ্ণের শরীরে সর্ব্ব-বিশ্বের বিশ্রাম ॥ ৯৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa eka sarvāśraya, kṛṣṇa sarva-dhāma
Kṛṣṇa alone the shelter of all Kṛṣṇa of all the abode
kṛṣṇera śarīre sarva-viśvera viśrāma
Kṛṣṇa's in the body of all the universes the repose

94 Kṛṣṇa alone is the shelter of all; Kṛṣṇa is the abode of all. All the universes rest in His body.

*(from the *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.1.1)*

দশমে দশমং লক্ষ্যমাশ্রিতাশ্রয়বিগ্রহম্ ।
শ্রীকৃষ্ণাখ্যং পরং ধাম জগদ্ধাম নমামি তৎ ॥ ৯৫ ॥

daśame daśamaṁ lakṣyam
in the Tenth the tenth subject
āśritāśraya-vigraham
of the sheltered of the shelter the embodiment
śrī-kṛṣṇākhyaṁ paraṁ dhāma
called Śrī Kṛṣṇa the supreme abode
jagad-dhāma namāmi tat
of the world the abode I bow to that

95 "The Tenth Canto reveals the tenth subject, the embodiment of the shelter of all who take shelter. I bow to that supreme abode called Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the abode of the universe." (Śrīdhara Svāmī, Bhāvārtha-dīpikā on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.1.1)

Anubhāṣya.
daśame (in the Tenth Canto of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*) **āśritāśraya-vigraham** (the form who is the shelter of the *āśritas*, the surrendered souls) **daśamam** (the tenth, that is, the *āśraya-tattva*) **lakṣyam** (is pointed out) **tat paraṁ dhāma** (that supreme abode, the best shelter), **jagad-dhāma** (the abode of the universe, the shelter of all), **śrī-kṛṣṇākhyam** (named Śrī Kṛṣṇa), **namāmi** (I worship).

The basis of knowledge about Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ, আর শক্তিত্রয়-জ্ঞান ।
যাঁর হয়, তাঁর নাহি কৃষ্ণেতে অজ্ঞান ॥ ৯৬ ॥

kṛṣṇera svarūpa, āra śakti-traya-jñāna
of Kṛṣṇa the own form and of the three potencies knowledge
yāṅra haya, tāṅra nāhi kṛṣṇete ajñāna
whose is his there is not about Kṛṣṇa ignorance

96 One who knows Kṛṣṇa's own form and His three potencies is never ignorant about Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The three potencies are the *cit-śakti*, the *jīva-śakti* and the *māyā-śakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (16): “The one Supreme Truth, by Its own natural inconceivable potency, always abides in four ways: as Its *svarūpa*, as the manifestations of the *svarūpa* (*vaibhava*), as the *jīvas* and as *pradhāna*. So too the radiance within the sun's disc abides as the disc itself, as the rays issuing from it, and as their reflection. Inconceivability is the power to accomplish the impossible. Potency is of three kinds: internal, external and marginal. By the internal potency, called *svarūpa-śakti*, the Truth abides in Its full form and in the manifestations of that form, Vaikuṇṭha and the rest. By the marginal potency It abides as the pure *jīvas*: they are like the rays, spiritual and one with It in nature. By the external potency, called *māyā*, It abides as *pradhāna*: this is Its external, material manifestation, like the play of colors in a reflection. These are the four ways. The *jīva* is a part of It and therefore the marginal potency, while *pradhāna* belongs to *māyā*; with this in view the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* counts three potencies. The potency whose work (*karma*) is ignorance (*avidyā*) is named there *avidyā-karma*; this is *māyā*. Although it is external, it has the power to cover even the *jīva*, who consists of the marginal potency. Its covering lies on bodies from Brahmā down to the unmoving beings, now lighter, now heavier. *Pradhāna* lacks such qualities as spirituality and changelessness; one should understand that it is this inconceivable *māyā* that makes it material and changeable. The internal, marginal and external potencies are one in nature [with the Truth]. It is said here only that each of them resembles its image in one respect, not in all: they take the place of the disc, the rays and the reflection, but are not identical with them. Therefore the defects of these images do not apply here.”

This one Supreme Truth, by the power of a natural potency beyond human understanding, always abides in four ways: as the *svarūpa*, as the manifestations of the *svarūpa*, as the *jīva* and as *pradhāna*. So too the sun has four aspects: the radiance within the disc, the disc itself, the rays issuing from the disc, and their reflection. Inconceivability means that the Truth accomplishes the impossible. Potency, too, is of three kinds: internal, external and marginal. The internal *svarūpa-śakti* reveals the full form of the *svarūpa* and its manifestations — Vaikuṇṭha, Goloka and the rest. The marginal potency reveals the spiritual forms of the pure *jīvas*, which are like the rays. The external potency, *māyā*, reveals the

external manifestation connected with the Truth — material *pradhāna*, like the play of colors in a reflection. These are the four ways. The *jīva* is a part of It and therefore the marginal potency, while *pradhāna* belongs to *māyā*; understanding this, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* counts three potencies. The potency that does the work of ignorance (*avidyā*) is called *māyā*. This potency is external, and yet it is given the power to cover the *jīva*, who consists of the marginal potency. The *jīvas* covered by *māyā* abide, to a greater or lesser degree, in bodies from the unmoving beings up to Brahmā. *Pradhāna* lacks such qualities as spirituality and changelessness — it is material and changeable; one should know that this happens only by the will of the inconceivable *māyā*. The internal, marginal and external potencies are one in nature, and they are equal in being potencies. But they do not resemble each other in everything: it is said of them only that they take the place [of the disc, the rays and the reflection], not that they are those images. Therefore the defects proper to the marginal and external potencies have no place in the internal potency. Nor do the defects of the external potency have a place in the marginal, or those of the marginal in the external.

কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপের হয় ষড্বিধ বিলাস ।
প্রাভব-বৈভব-রূপে দ্বিবিধ প্রকাশ ॥ ৯৭ ॥

kṛṣṇera svarūpera haya ṣaḍ-vidha vilāsa
of Kṛṣṇa of the own form are six kinds of pastime forms
prābhava-vaibhava-rūpe dvi-vidha prakāśa
prābhava vaibhava in the forms two kinds of manifestation

97 Kṛṣṇa's own form has six kinds of pastime forms (*vilāsa*). His manifestations are of two kinds, *prābhava* and *vaibhava*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Prābhava and *vaibhava* are those whose forms, full of being, consciousness and bliss, are equal to Hari's, but who are slightly below His supreme state. Their names depend on the measure of potency: where lordship (*prabhutā*) predominates, there is *prābhava*; where greatness (*vibhutā*) predominates, *vaibhava*. *Prābhava* is of two kinds. *Prābhavas* of the first kind remain in the world only briefly: for example, Mohinī, Haṁsa, Śukla and other short-lived avatāras connected with particular ages. The fame of *prābhavas* of the second kind does not spread very widely: for example, Dhanvantari, Ṛṣabha, Vyāsa,

Dattātreya, Kapila and others. But Kūrma, Matsya, Nara-Nārāyaṇa, Varāha, Hayagrīva, Pṛśnigarbha, Baladeva and the avatāras of the fourteen *manvantaras* — Yajña, Vibhu, Satyasena, Hari, Vaikuṇṭha, Ajita, Vāmana, Sārvabhauma, Ṛṣabha, Viṣvaksena, Dharmasetu, Sudhāmā, Yogeśvara and Bṛhadbhānu — are *vaibhava-avatāras*.

অংশ-শক্ত্যাবেশরূপে দ্বিবিধাবতার ।
বাল্য-পৌগণ্ড-ধর্ম্ম দুই ত' প্রকার ॥ ৯৮ ॥

aṁśa-śaktyāveśa-rūpe dvi-vidhāvatāra
partial empowered in the forms two kinds of avatāras
bālya-paugaṇḍa-dharma dui ta' prakāra
of childhood of boyhood the characteristics two indeed kinds

98 His avatāras are of two kinds: partial avatāras and empowered avatāras (*śaktyāveśa*). There are two further kinds: His forms of childhood and of boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *aṁśāveśa-* and *śaktyāveśa-avatāras* are explained elsewhere. They too are counted among the *prābhavas* and *vaibhavas*. The same holds for the *guṇa-avatāras*.

কিশোরস্বরূপ কৃষ্ণ স্বয়ং অবতারী ।
ক্রীড়া করে এই ছয়-রূপে বিশ্ব ভরি' ॥ ৯৯ ॥

kiśora-svarūpa kṛṣṇa svayaṁ avatārī
youthful own form Kṛṣṇa Himself the source of avatāras
krīḍā kare ei chaya-rūpe viśva bhari'
pastimes performs in these six forms the universe filling

99 Kṛṣṇa in His own youthful form (*kiśora*) is Himself the source of all avatāras. He sports in these six forms and fills the universe.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa is eternally youthful (*nitya-kiśora*), and He has two kinds of pastimes, in childhood (*bālya*) and in boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*). Therefore the source of the avatāras Himself is precisely Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form.

এই ছয়-রূপে হয় অনন্ত বিভেদ ।
অনন্তরূপে একরূপ, নাহি কিছু ভেদ ॥ ১০০ ॥

ei chaya-rūpe haya ananta vibheda
in these six forms are endless varieties
ananta-rūpe eka-rūpa, nāhi kichu bheda
in endless forms one form there is not any difference

100 These six forms have endless varieties. Yet in all these endless forms He is one form; there is no difference at all.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa* displays six kinds of *vilāsa*: two kinds of manifestation, *prābhava* and *vaibhava*; two kinds of avatāra, *aṁśa* and *śaktyāveśa*; and two ages, *bālya* and *paugaṇḍa*. In these six kinds of *vilāsa* of His *svarūpa*, Kṛṣṇa in His youthful form performs pastimes throughout the universe. Thus these six forms divide without end. But even having become endless, Kṛṣṇa remains the one undivided Truth.

*The *cit-śakti* and its manifestations —*

চিচ্ছক্তি, স্বরূপশক্তি, অন্তরঙ্গা নাম ।
তাহার বৈভব অনন্ত বৈকুণ্ঠাদি ধাম ॥ ১০১ ॥

cic-chakti, svarūpa-śakti, antaraṅgā nāma
the spiritual potency His own potency internal named
tāhāra vaibhava ananta vaikuṇṭhādi dhāma
its opulence countless Vaikuṇṭha and other abodes

101 The spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) is called His very own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*) and the internal potency. Its opulence is the countless abodes such as Vaikuṇṭha.

*The *māyā-śakti* and its manifestations —*

মায়াশক্তি, বহিরঙ্গা, জগৎকারণ ।
তাহার বৈভব অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ডের গণ ॥ ১০২ ॥

māyā-śakti, bahiraṅgā, jagat-kāraṇa
the potency māyā external the cause of the world
tāhāra vaibhava ananta brahmāṇḍera gaṇa
its opulence countless of universes multitudes

102 The potency called māyā is external and is the cause of the material world. Its opulence is the countless multitudes of universes.

*The *jīva-śakti* —*

জীবশক্তি তটস্থাখ্য, নাহি যার অন্ত ।
মুখ্য তিন শক্তি, তার বিভেদ অনন্ত ॥ ১০৩ ॥

jīva-śakti taṭasthākhya, nāhi yāra anta
the potency of the jīvas called marginal there is not whose end
mukhya tina śakti, tāra vibheda ananta
principal three potencies their varieties endless

103 The potency of the living beings is called marginal (*taṭastha*), and it has no end. These are the three principal potencies, and their varieties are endless.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *cit-śakti*, or *svarūpa-śakti*, is also called the internal potency. From it come the endless manifestations of splendor in Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes. From the marginal potency, the *jīva-śakti*, come the countless *jīvas*, conditioned and liberated. From the external potency, the *māyā-śakti*, comes the endless variety of material universes.

Anubhāṣya.
Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad, Chapter 6, mantra 8: “He has no work and no organs of action; no one is seen equal to Him or higher than Him. The Śrutis say that His supreme potency is manifold, and knowledge, strength and action belong to Him by nature.”

*Where the forms of the *svarūpa* and the potencies abide —*

এই ত' স্বরূপগণ, আর তিন শক্তি ।
সবার আশ্রয় কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণে সবার স্থিতি ॥ ১০৪ ॥

ei ta' svarūpa-gaṇa, āra tina śakti
these indeed of His own forms the multitude and three potencies
sabāra āśraya kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇe sabāra sthiti
of all the shelter Kṛṣṇa in Kṛṣṇa of all the existence

104 These are His own forms and the three potencies. Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of them all, and all of them exist in Kṛṣṇa.

যদ্যপি ব্রহ্মাণ্ডগণের পুরুষ আশ্রয় ।
সেহ পুরুষাদি সবার কৃষ্ণ মূলাশ্রয় ॥ ১০৫ ॥

yadyapi brahmāṇḍa-gaṇera puruṣa āśraya
although of the universes multitude the Puruṣa the shelter
seha puruṣādi sabāra kṛṣṇa mūlāśraya
of those the Puruṣa and others all Kṛṣṇa the original shelter

105 Although the Puruṣa is the shelter of all the universes, Kṛṣṇa is the original shelter of the Puruṣa and of all the others.

Who Kṛṣṇa is —

স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্বাশ্রয় ।
পরম ঈশ্বর কৃষ্ণ সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রে কয় ॥ ১০৬ ॥

svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa sarvāśraya
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa the shelter of all
parama īśvara kṛṣṇa sarva-śāstre kaya
supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa in all scriptures is said

106 Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Lord Himself; Kṛṣṇa is the shelter of all. All the scriptures declare that Kṛṣṇa is the supreme Lord.

*(*Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.1)*

ঈশ্বরঃ পরমঃ কৃষ্ণঃ সচ্চিদানন্দবিগ্রহঃ ।
অনাদিরাদির্গোবিন্দঃ সর্ব্বকারণকারণম্ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

īśvaraḥ paramaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ
the Lord supreme Kṛṣṇa
sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ
of eternity knowledge bliss whose form
anādir ādir govindaḥ
without beginning the beginning Govinda
sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam
of all causes the cause

107 "Kṛṣṇa, who is Govinda, is the supreme Lord. His form is eternity, knowledge and bliss. He has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all, the cause of all causes." (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Supreme Lord is Kṛṣṇa, the form of being, consciousness and bliss. He Himself has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all and the cause of all causes.

Anubhāṣya.

kṛṣṇaḥ (Kṛṣṇa, Vrajendranandana) **paramaḥ īśvaraḥ** (the Supreme Lord. He is the Master of all: of Baladeva, Nārāyaṇa, Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; of the *puruṣa-avatāras*, the Paramātmās who lie in the three oceans — Kāraṇa, Garbha and Kṣīrārṇava; of the *naimittika-avatāras* — Matsya, Kūrma, Varāha, Rāma, Nṛsiṁha and others; of the *guṇa-avatāras* — Brahmā, Śiva and others; of the impersonal Brahman; and of the *vibhūti-avatāras* — Mahendra and the rest) **sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ** (the form of being, consciousness and bliss, endowed with three potencies: *sandhinī*, *saṁvit* and *hlādinī*) **anādiḥ** (without beginning; of Him it is said, "I alone was in the beginning.") **ādiḥ** (the original form of all) **sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam** (the cause, the root, of all causes) **govindaḥ** (Govinda).

এ সব সিদ্ধান্ত তুমি জান ভালমতে ।
তবু পূর্ব্বপক্ষ কর আমা চালাইতে ॥ ১০৮ ॥

e saba siddhānta tumi jāna bhāla-mate
these all conclusions you know well
tabu pūrva-pakṣa kara āmā cālāite
still objections you make me to unsettle

108 You know all these conclusions well, yet you raise objections to unsettle me.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Calāite means "to unsettle me needlessly."

Śrī Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa, Himself the source of the avatāras —

সেই কৃষ্ণ অবতারী ব্রজেন্দ্রকুমার ।
আপনে চৈতন্যরূপে কৈল অবতার ॥ ১০৯ ॥

sei kṛṣṇa avatārī vrajendra-kumāra
that Kṛṣṇa the source of avatāras the son of the king of Vraja
āpane caitanya-rūpe kaila avatāra
Himself in the form of Caitanya made descent

109 That Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja, the source of the avatāras, has Himself descended in the form of Caitanya.

In Śrī Caitanya, the source of the avatāras, all the avatāras are contained —

অতএব চৈতন্য-গোসাঞি পরতত্ত্ব-সীমা ।
তাঁরে ক্ষীরোদশায়ী কহি, কি তাঁর মহিমা ॥ ১১০ ॥

ataeva caitanya-gosāñi paratattva-sīmā
therefore Caitanya Gosāñi of the Supreme Truth the utmost limit
tāṅre kṣīroda-śāyī kahi, ki tāṅra mahimā
Him Kṣīrodaśāyī calling what His glory

110 Therefore Lord Caitanya is the utmost limit of the Supreme Truth. What glory is there in calling Him Kṣīrodaśāyī?

Therefore it is no error to call Him by any name of Viṣṇu —

সেই ত' ভক্তের বাক্য নহে ব্যভিচারী ।
সকল সম্ভবে তাঁতে, যাতে অবতারী ॥ ১১১ ॥

sei ta' bhaktera vākya nahe vyabhicārī
those indeed of a devotee words are not wrong
sakala sambhave tāṅte, yāte avatārī
all is possible in Him since the source of avatāras

111 Yet such words of a devotee are not wrong. Everything is possible in Him, since He is the source of the avatāras.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Caitanya-bhāgavata, Madhya, Chapter 6, 95: "I was lying in the Ocean of Milk — and Nāḍā's roar broke My sleep."[0]

অবতারীর দেহে সব অবতারের স্থিতি ।
কেহো কোনমতে কহে, যেমন যার মতি ॥ ১১২ ॥

avatārīra dehe saba avatārera sthiti
of the source of avatāras in the body all avatāras' existence
keho kona-mate kahe, yemana yāra mati
someone in some way speaks as whose understanding

112 All the avatāras exist within the body of Him who is their source. So people speak of Him in different ways, each according to his understanding.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In some books Śrī Caitanya is called Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha. This does not describe His greatness fully, yet the words of those devotees are not false either. For Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who is non-different from Kṛṣṇa, is Himself the source of the avatāras, and so all the avatāras abide in Him.

কৃষ্ণকে কহয়ে কেহ — নরনারায়ণ ।
কেহো কহে, কৃষ্ণ হয় সাক্ষাৎ বামন ॥ ১১৩ ॥

kṛṣṇake kahaye keha — nara-nārāyaṇa
Kṛṣṇa calls someone Nara-Nārāyaṇa
keho kahe, kṛṣṇa haya sākṣāt vāmana
someone says Kṛṣṇa is directly Vāmana

113 Some call Kṛṣṇa Nara-Nārāyaṇa, and some say that Kṛṣṇa is Vāmana Himself.

কেহো কহে, কৃষ্ণ ক্ষীরোদশায়ী অবতার ।
অসম্ভব নহে, সত্য বচন সবার ॥ ১১৪ ॥

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa kṣīroda-śāyī avatāra
someone says Kṛṣṇa of Kṣīrodaśāyī an avatāra
asambhava nahe, satya vacana sabāra
impossible is not true the words of all

114 Some say that Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of Kṣīrodaśāyī. That is not impossible; the words of all of them are true.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where Kṛṣṇa is described as the source of the avatāras, it is said: “Therefore in the Purāṇas and other scriptures the sages, following particular events, name Kṛṣṇa differently: some call Him Narasakha, the Friend of Nara; others, the younger brother of Mahendra; still others, the One who lies in the Ocean of Milk; some, the Thousand-headed One; and some, the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha.”

কেহো কহে, পরব্যোমে নারায়ণ-হরি ।
সকল সম্ভবে কৃষ্ণে, যাতে অবতারী ॥ ১১৫ ॥

keho kahe, para-vyome nārāyaṇa-hari
someone says in the spiritual sky Nārāyaṇa Hari
sakala sambhave kṛṣṇe, yāte avatārī
all is possible in Kṛṣṇa since the source of avatāras

115 Some call Him Hari, the Nārāyaṇa of the spiritual sky. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa, since He is the source of the avatāras.

*All devotees, on the path of *vaidhī* and on the path of *rāgānugā* alike, absolutely need to know the conclusions of devotion —*

সব শ্রোতাগণের করি চরণ বন্দন ।
এ সব সিদ্ধান্ত শুন, করি' এক মন ॥ ১১৬ ॥

saba śrotā-gaṇera kari caraṇa vandana
of all the listeners I do to the feet obeisance
e saba siddhānta śuna, kari' eka mana
these all conclusions hear making one mind

116 I bow at the feet of all my listeners. Hear all these conclusions with undivided attention.

সিদ্ধান্ত বলিয়া চিত্তে না কর অলস ।
ইহা হৈতে কৃষ্ণে লাগে সুদৃঢ় মানস ॥ ১১৭ ॥

siddhānta baliyā citte nā kara alasa
conclusions thinking (them) in the heart not be lazy
ihā haite kṛṣṇe lāge sudṛḍha mānasa
this from to Kṛṣṇa becomes attached firmly the mind

117 Do not let your heart grow lazy, thinking these are mere philosophical conclusions. Through them the mind becomes firmly attached to Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Some who thirst for devotion do not count these conclusions (*siddhāntas*) as part of devotion and are too lazy to study them. But this does not lead to good. For when one has understood one's relationship with Kṛṣṇa (*sambandha-jñāna*), the mind becomes firmly attached to His lotus feet. Therefore such true conclusions are the root of pure devotion.

Thus ends the second chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

[0]: The verse translation reads differently: it takes *ātma-kalpita* as "created by Himself" (as the *Anubhāṣya* also glosses it), whereas here it is read as "made one's own," that is, those who know themselves as the Lord's servants.

Anubhāṣya.

Many see the example of devotees in whom taste (*ruci*) has awakened and think it is not so necessary to study the conclusions (*siddhānta*). Out of such laziness many grow poor in worship (*bhajana*) and turn away from Kṛṣṇa. They take for devotion material feelings hostile to devotion, and fall under the sway of *anarthas*. The path led by reasoning suits those in whom taste has not yet awakened. Yet those in whom taste has awakened but is still weak have special need of hearing, a part of devotion (*śravaṇāṅga*). Without hearing the conclusions about Kṛṣṇa, taste does not grow. Among the nine kinds of devotion, hearing is prescribed at the very beginning, before glorification. The creeper of devotion grows only when it is watered with hearing and glorification. Even Brahmā, when he praised Kṛṣṇa and described the devotees who had given up the effort for knowledge, said: "…the news of You, resounding from the mouths of the sādhus and reaching the ear." The *Bhāgavatam* grants the pure knowledge of the *paramahaṁsas*. Only one who reads and hears it while reflecting on it attains the level of a *mahā-bhāgavata*. In Śrī Mahāprabhu's teachings to Sanātana we hear: "One who is expert in scripture and reasoning and has firm faith is a devotee of the highest level; he delivers the world." And Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmīpāda said that one must give up laziness: "Devotion is perfected by six qualities: enthusiasm, conviction, patience, carrying out the prescribed duties, giving up [bad] company, and following the conduct of the sādhus."[0]

Those who claim to be devotees without knowing the conclusions often, out of foolishness, artificially practice the *sāttvika-vikāras* (spiritual transformations), and so lower the standing of a Vaiṣṇava in people's eyes. Condemning this bad habit, the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* gives the verse *tad aśma-sāram…*.[0] In his commentary on it Śrīpāda Cakravartī Ṭhākura says: "If there are tears and thrilling outside but the heart is not transformed, that heart is made of stone. This censure is aimed at devotees of the lowest level (*kaniṣṭha-adhikārīs*): even when they have tears, thrilling and the like, their hearts are of stone." When the conclusions are not respected, artificial devotion appears; Śrī Rūpa Prabhu painted its picture like this: "In those whose hearts are slippery by nature, and in those who practice it, tears, thrilling and the like sometimes appear even without a semblance of *sattva*." Here too is a vivid example of how the crowd of false devotees, lacking the conclusions, take transformations of *māyā* for transcendental ones.

Many condemn even reading the works on *siddhānta* written by the Vaiṣṇava ācāryas — Śrī Rāmānuja, Madhvācārya, Nimbārka, Viṣṇusvāmī and others — just as they condemn studying the books of the Advaitavādīs, who are hostile to

devotion. Yet for the good of the Vaiṣṇavas Śrī Jīva quoted precisely their excellent conclusions in the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha*. The impersonalists (*nirviśeṣa-vādīs*) mistakenly take the parts of devotion for parts of karma. So too *jīvas* who are Vaiṣṇavas in name only, not knowing the conclusions, imagine that conclusions favorable to devotion are hostile to it — and fall away from devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

*Love for worship (*bhajana*) is born of the conclusions of devotion —*

চৈতন্য-মহিমা জানি এ সব সিদ্ধান্তে ।
চিত্ত দৃঢ় হঞা লাগে মহিমা-জ্ঞান হৈতে ॥ ১১৮ ॥

caitanya-mahimā jāni e saba siddhānte
of Caitanya the greatness one knows through these all conclusions
citta dṛḍha hañā lāge mahimā-jñāna haite
the heart firm becoming becomes attached of the greatness from knowing

118 Through all these conclusions one comes to know the greatness of Caitanya. Knowing His greatness, the heart grows firm and becomes attached to Him.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Pañcarātra*: “Firm love (*sneha*), surpassing all and joined with knowledge of [the Lord's] greatness, is called devotion; by it [one attains] *sārṣṭi* and the rest, and by nothing else.” “In those who follow the path of rules it is joined with knowledge of His greatness; but in those who have taken shelter of *rāgānugā* it is usually pure (*kevala*).”

The author describes the truth about Kṛṣṇa only to establish faith in Caitanya —

চৈতন্যপ্রভুর মহিমা কহিবার তরে ।
কৃষ্ণের মহিমা কহি করিয়া বিস্তারে ॥ ১১৯ ॥

caitanya-prabhura mahimā kahibāra tare
of Caitanya Mahāprabhu the greatness to tell in order to
kṛṣṇera mahimā kahi kariyā vistāre
of Kṛṣṇa the greatness I tell doing in detail

119 To tell the greatness of Caitanya Mahāprabhu, I have described the greatness of Kṛṣṇa in detail.

He who is Kṛṣṇa is Caitanya —

চৈতন্য-গোসাঞির এই তত্ত্ব-নিরূপণ ।
স্বয়ং ভগবান্ কৃষ্ণ ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ১২০ ॥

caitanya-gosāñira ei tattva-nirūpaṇa
of Caitanya Gosāñi this of the truth the determination
svayaṁ bhagavān kṛṣṇa vrajendra-nandana
Himself Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa the son of the king of Vraja

120 This is the established truth about Lord Caitanya: He is Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Lord Himself, the son of the king of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the second chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

[0]: The edition reads *atan-māyā-rahita* (literally “free from *māyā*, [which is] not-That”); taken here as “untouched by *māyā*.” [0]: The edition reads *māyā vā advaya-jñāna-dvārā* (“by *māyā*, or nondual knowledge”); the sense probably requires *dvaya-jñāna*, dual knowledge (compare *dvaita-jñāna* in the same sentence); translated by the sense. [0]: *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.1.1–3. [0]: Sources not named in the edition: *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.7 and 3.12; *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.1.3; *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.5.33–34 and 7.9.38. [0]: *Māyāyām*, literally “in Māyā”; usually understood as Māyāpura. [0]: *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 2.2.13; *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.13. [0]: Nāḍā is a nickname of Advaita Ācārya. [0]: *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.14.3; *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 22.65; *Upadeśāmṛta* 3. [0]: *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.3.24.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১২১ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
Caitanya-caritāmṛta tells Kṛṣṇadāsa

121 Ever hoping for the mercy of the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *prakāśa*, “manifestation,” which is translated here; other editions read *vilāsa*, “pastime form.” ↩